Monthly Travel Indicators Summary

January 2026

March 10, 2026

About the Monthly Travel Indicators Summary

The Monthly Travel Indicators Summary is a summary compilation of key indicators and statistics from a variety of Visit California and third-party data sets for the reporting month, including:

Visit California Sources	Third Party Sources
AirDNA	Bureau of Labor Statistics (BLS)
CIC Research	Department of Homeland Security (DHS)
Cirium	Department of Labor
CoStar	U.S. Energy Information Administration (EIA)
Future Partners	University of Michigan
NTTO	
SMARInsights	
Tourism Economics	
YouGov	

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Executive Summary Domestic

Forecast (updated February 2026)

According to Tourism Economics' February forecast, California's visitor volume is projected to rise 1.8% in 2026, adding 4.9 million visits for a total of 276.6 million. Visitor spending is forecast to grow 3.5% to $164.8 billion.

Macroeconomic

Macroeconomic indicators showed modest improvement in January, with inflation falling to 2.4% and unemployment edging down to 4.3%. Job growth was solid for the month; however, downward revisions to 2025 figures underscore an economy characterized by low unemployment alongside subdued job expansion. Consumer sentiment increased slightly during the month but remains well below January 2025 levels.

- The Bureau of Labor Statistics (BLS) reported a January inflation rate of 2.4%, down from 2.7% month prior.
- The national average retail price for a gallon of gas was $2.94, down eight cents from December. The average price in California was $4.13, down 17 cents.
- One hundred thirty thousand jobs were added to the economy in January and the unemployment rate improved to 4.3. However, downward revisions of 2025 job numbers highlighted slower growth last year.
- The University of Michigan's U.S. Consumer Sentiment Index was 56.4 for the month, increasing more than 3 points for the second consecutive month. Sentiment remained well down from the 71.1 reading in January 2025.

Consumer Sentiment

Consumer sentiment related to travel generally remains unchanged from prior months. California residents continue to track closer to the U.S. overall, whereas historically they have trended more positive.

- Consumer tracking from Future Partners shows that "travel is too expensive right now" and "personal financial reasons" were the top two deterrents to travel in the past six months, with 33% of U.S. travelers selecting each response. California residents were somewhat more likely to indicate "travel is too expensive right now" at 36%. Air travel costs remain a deterrent nationally but at a lower rate, while gas costs as a travel deterrent have trended down, mirroring gas price trends.
- A third of U.S. travelers (33%) and California residents (33%) reported feeling "better off" about their current financial situation relative to a year ago. Looking ahead, U.S. travelers expressed optimism about their future financial outlook (45% "better off"), while California residents (43% "better off") were slightly more pessimistic relative to the U.S. overall. These rates have generally trended downward over the last two years.
- However, excitement for travel remained high, with 88% of U.S. travelers saying they were excited about leisure travel in the next 12 months.
- In terms of competitive destination demand, 47% of American travelers and 54% of California resident travelers said they were considering international leisure travel within the next 12 months.

Executive Summary Domestic (continued)

Lodging

The state had a strong start to the year in terms of hotel performance. California exceeded the U.S. overall for the month, with ADR primarily driving the growth. Revenue for the state grew nearly 3% for the month. Group demand and revenue also saw strong growth.

- Hotel room demand in California grew 1.1% for the month while room revenue grew 2.9%. The San Francisco Bay Area region continued to show robust growth with demand growing 6% and revenue growing 10% in January. The High Sierra region saw revenue grow by nearly 12% for the month.
- The state's monthly occupancy rate was 60% (+0.7% YOY), with an average daily rate (ADR) of $190 (+1.8% YOY) and revenue per available room (RevPAR) of $114 (+2.5% YOY). By comparison, overall U.S. RevPAR grew 0.4% for the month.
- Group demand in the state grew 5.9% for the month and revenues grew nearly 12%. Orange County reported the largest growth rates at 28% and 33% respectively.
- For January, the occupancy rate for short-term rentals in California stood at 54% (+0.9% YOY). ADR grew by 2.3% and RevPAR grew 3.2% (vs. 1.7% for the U.S.).

Airlift

National TSA passenger screenings were flat for the month, while California airport screenings declined 0.6%. Airlift to California, measured by nonstop seats, declined 2.1% for the month, marking the sixth consecutive month of reduced airlift.

- In total, 65.9 million passengers were screened at TSA checkpoints nationwide for the month, flat compared with January 2025. California's 8.0 million screenings for the month was down 0.6%.
- Non-stop domestic seat capacity to California destinations totaled 8.6 million for the month, down 2.1% year over year. Airlift has trended down six months in a row now.

Executive Summary International

Forecast (updated February 2026)

International visitation is forecast to grow 2.7% in 2026 to 16.6 million, nearly matching 2024 visitation levels. Visitation from all thirteen priority markets is estimated to grow moderately in 2026, but many markets are not expected to recover to 2024 levels until 2027 or later.

Consumer Sentiment

Consumer sentiment around international leisure travel in Visit California's 13 priority markets has remained steady in recent months. Price continues to be the primary barrier to travel overall, and consumers are expressing lower intent to travel to the United States compared with a year ago. Consideration of travel to the U.S. and California remains below 2024 levels, particularly among Canadian and European consumers.

- International leisure travel intent is highest in Germany (58%) and the Nordics (60%). Rates have declined in Australia (36% vs 39% PY) and Canada (38% vs 42% PY).
- Travel costs remained the primary barrier to travel among international consumers. Consumers from South Korea, France and Canada were most likely to cite trave costs as a barrier (51% South Korea, 50% France, and 49% Canada).
- Across the 13 priority markets, 13% of international consumers indicated they were planning to visit the U.S., down from a 16% average in January 2025 and 18% in 2024. Consumers in 10 out of the 13 priority markets were less likely to consider travel to the U.S. relative to the same period a year ago. Comparable intent to travel to California averaged 10% in December (vs. 12% in 2025 and 2024.)

Airlift/Arrivals

While international airlift to California grew modestly in January, air arrivals from the state's priority markets declined 9.1%, slightly worse than the prior month (-7.8% in December). Canadian arrivals continued to trend downward (-14.3%) and will likely decline through the first quarter before beginning to recover. Arrivals from European markets were also flat to negative for the month. Mexico continued to shine, with 18.8% growth for the month.

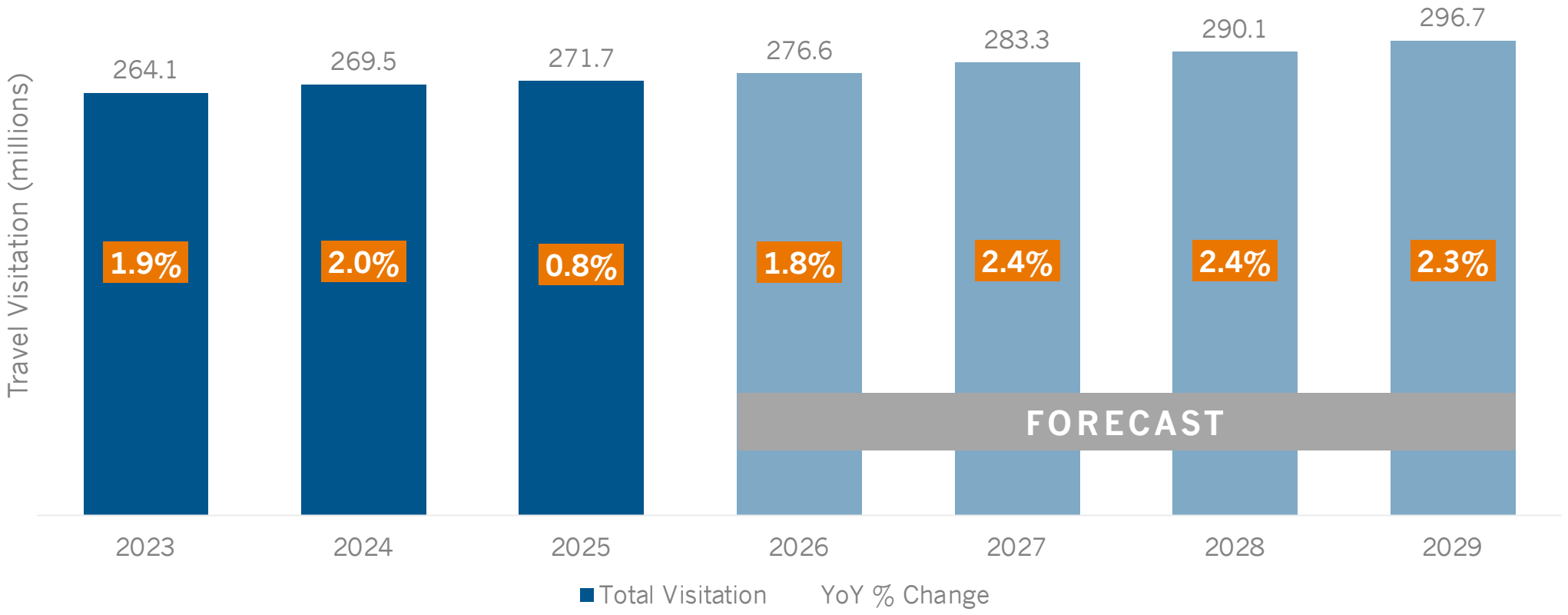
- In total, there were 1.5 million nonstop seats to California from Visit California's 13 priority markets for the month, up 1.6% from prior year. Among overseas markets, Japan, the U.K. and Australia had the largest volume of nonstop seats to California. Non-stop airlift from Italy grew by 120% for the month.
- International non-resident air arrivals from priority markets to California's ports of entry declined 9.1% in January. Canada continued to drive the decline in volume, however, the decline in arrivals from Canada has continued to moderate – down 14.3% in January vs. -19.9% prior month. Arrivals from Mexico in January grew nearly 19% for the month. China's 20.2% decline in January was likely due to the calendar shift of the Lunar New Year holiday from January to February in 2026.

Domestic Indicators: Forecast

- Total Visitation & Spending Forecast
- Domestic Spending Forecast

California Visitation Forecast

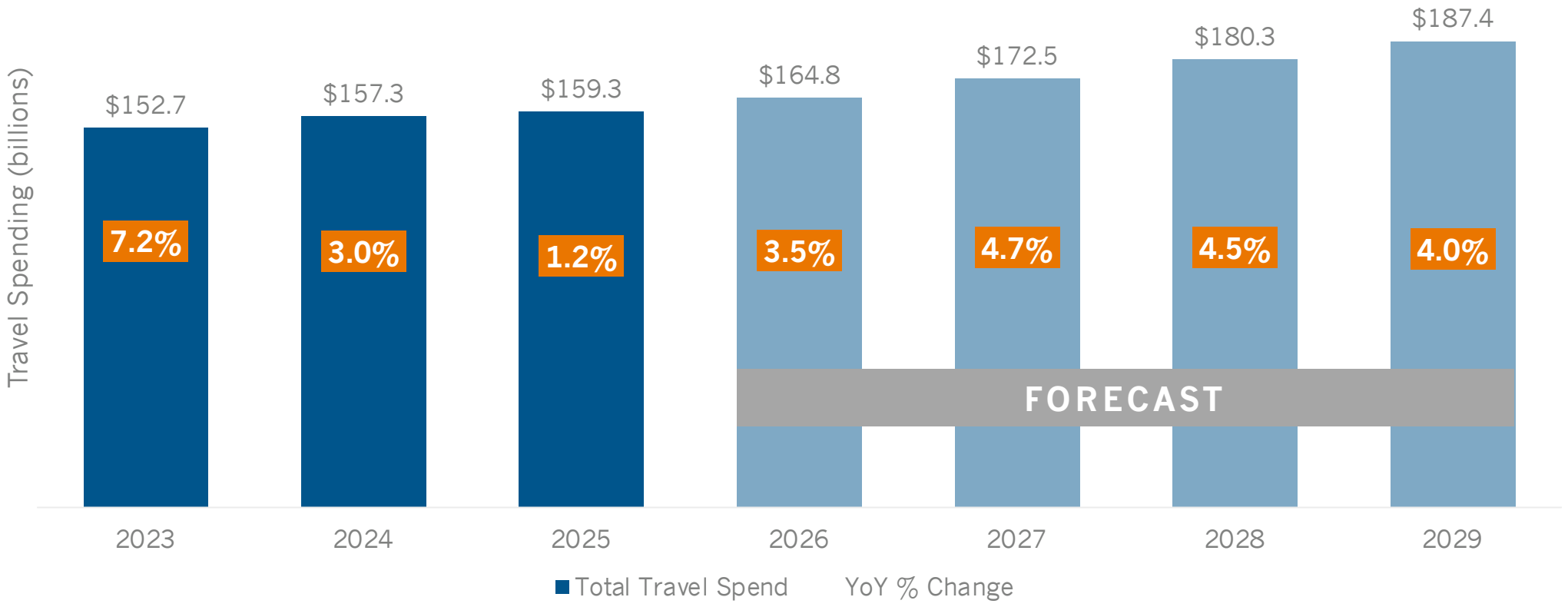
The chart below shows the current visitation forecast (domestic and international) and annual growth rate.



Source: Tourism Economics (Feb 2026)

California Spending Forecast

The chart below shows the current travel spending forecast (domestic and international) and annual growth rate.



Source: Tourism Economics (Feb 2026)

California Visitation Forecast: Domestic

Visits (millions)	2024	2025	2026	YoY % Chg	2024	2025	2026
Total visits	**269.5**	**271.7**	**276.6**	**Total visits**	**2.0%**	**0.8%**	**1.8%**
Domestic Total	**253.0**	**255.5**	**260.0**	**Domestic Total**	**1.6%**	**1.0%**	**1.7%**
Business	40.7	40.9	41.4	Business	4.1%	0.5%	1.2%
Group	7.1	7.3	7.5	*Group*	11.9%	3.0%	2.2%
Leisure	212.3	214.6	218.5	Leisure	1.1%	1.1%	1.8%

Source: Tourism Economics (Feb 2026)

California Spend Forecast: Domestic

Spending (billions)	2024	2025	2026	YoY % Chg	2024	2025	2026
Total travel spending	**$157.3**	**$159.3**	**$164.8**	**Total travel spending**	**3.0%**	**1.2%**	**3.5%**
Domestic Total	**$131.3**	**$134.4**	**$138.4**	**Domestic Total**	**0.9%**	**2.3%**	**3.0%**
Business	$28.4	$29.0	$29.9	Business	2.0%	2.2%	3.3%
Group	$4.9	$5.1	$5.3	*Group*	9.6%	4.8%	4.4%
Leisure	$102.9	$105.4	$108.5	Leisure	0.6%	2.4%	3.0%

Source: Tourism Economics (Feb 2026)

Domestic Indicators:

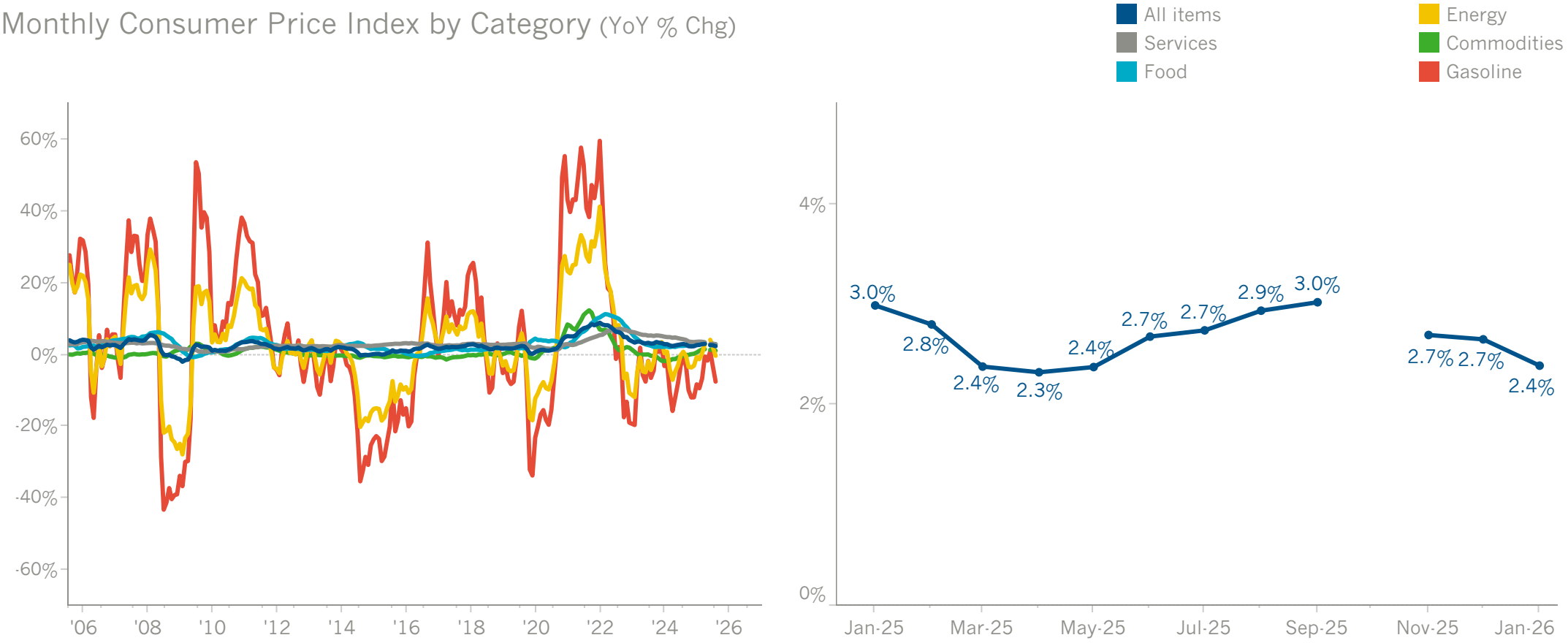
Macroeconomic

- CPI
- Gas Prices
- Jobs/Unemployment Rate
- Consumer Sentiment

U.S. Inflation Rate

The charts below show the national Consumer Price Index as a percent change compared to same month in the prior year.

Monthly Consumer Price Index by Category (YoY % Chg)

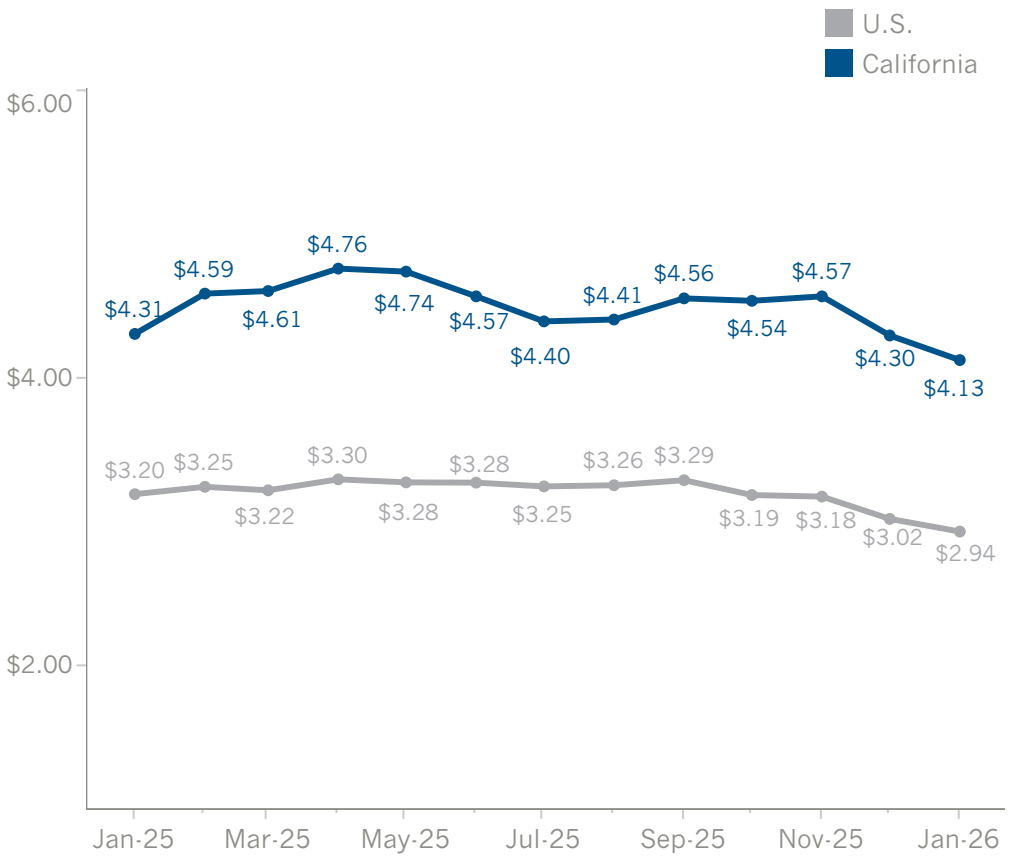


Source: Bureau of Labor Statistics (BLS)

U.S. & California Gas Prices

The charts below show the U.S. and California monthly average retail gas prices for all grades.

Monthly Average Gas Prices ($ per gallon)

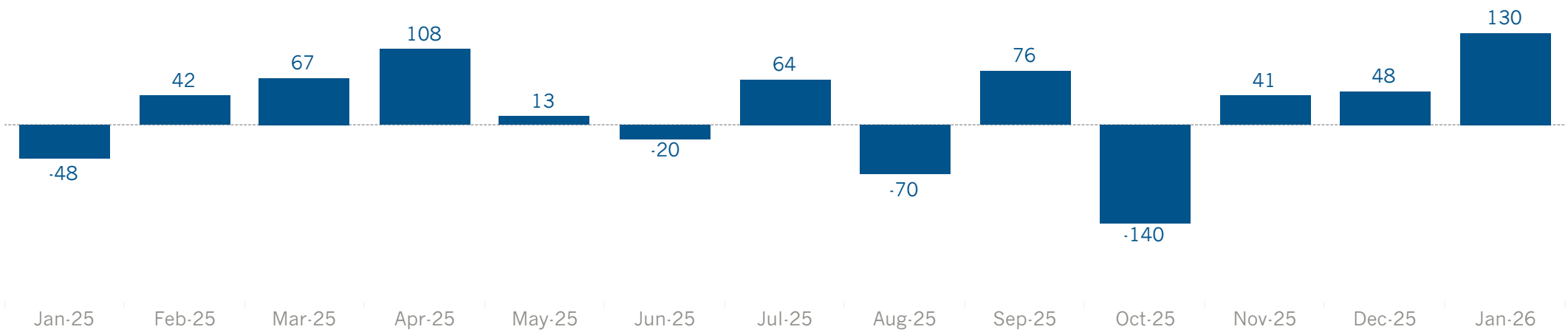


Source: U.S. Energy Information Administration (EIA)

U.S. Jobs Added/Lost & Unemployment Rate

The chart below shows the net U.S. non-farm jobs gained or lost for the month and the table shows the U.S. unemployment rate.

U.S. Net Jobs Added/Lost from Prior Month ('000)



U.S. Unemployment Rate (%)

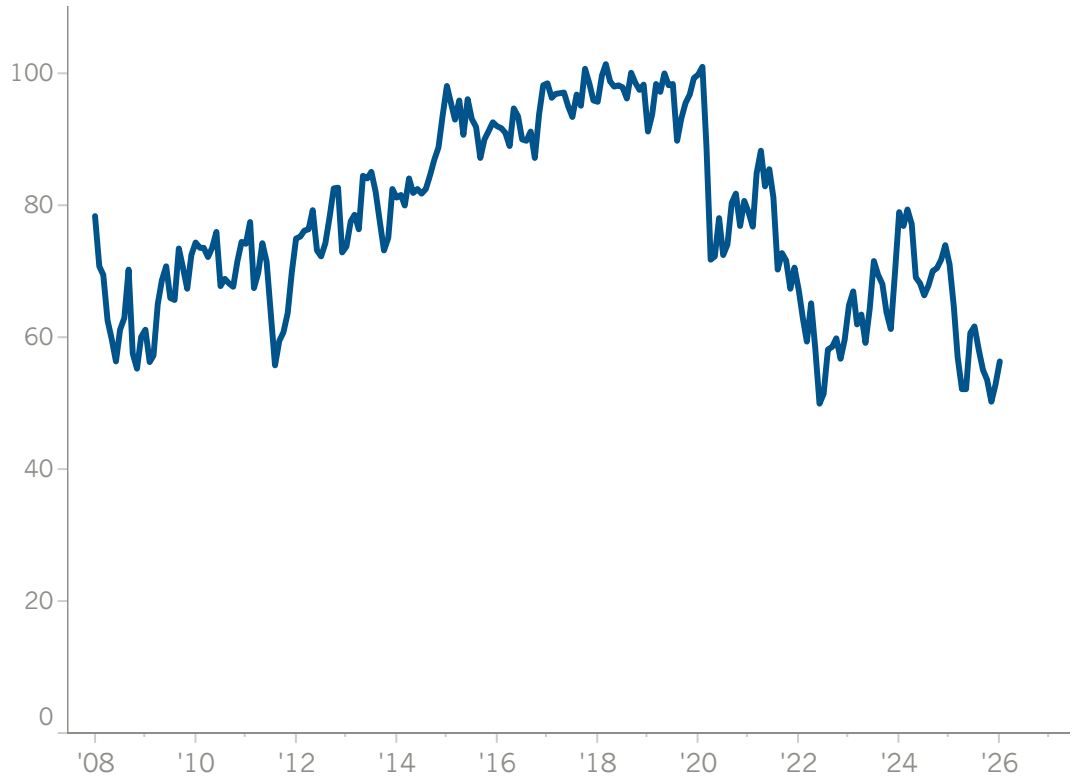
4.0%	4.1%	4.2%	4.2%	4.2%	4.1%	4.2%	4.3%	4.4%		4.6%	4.4%	4.3%

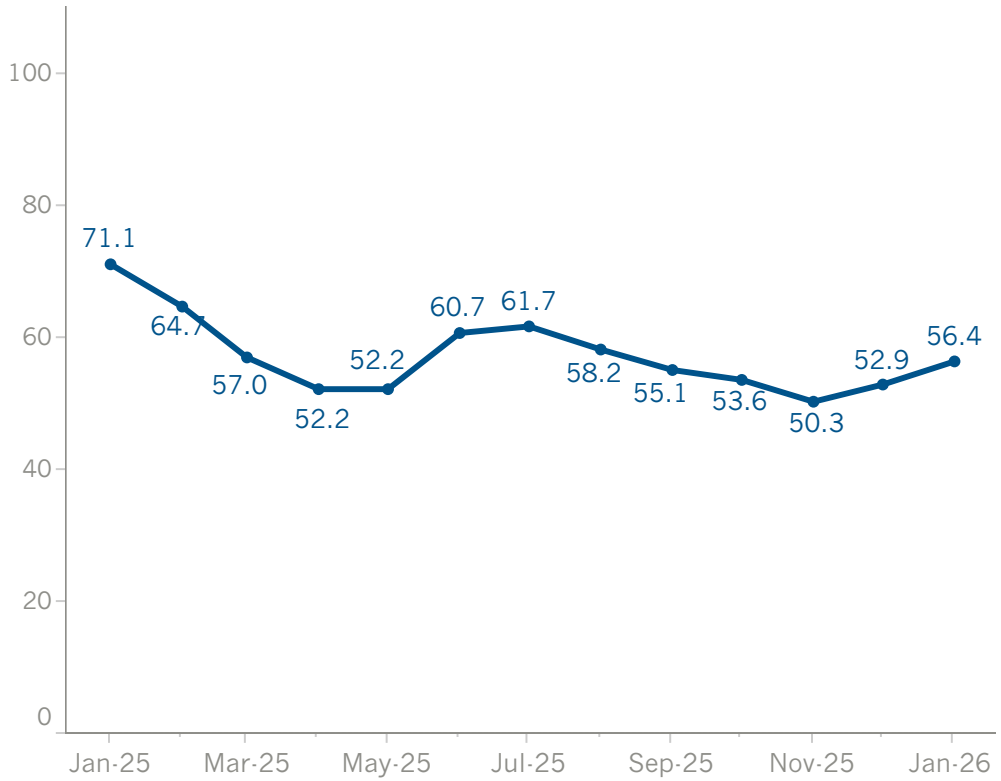
Source: Bureau of Labor Statistics (BLS)

U.S. Economic Consumer Sentiment

The charts below show the U.S. monthly consumer sentiment about the economy as an index.

U.S. Index of Consumer Sentiment





Source: University of Michigan

Domestic Indicators:

Consumer Sentiment

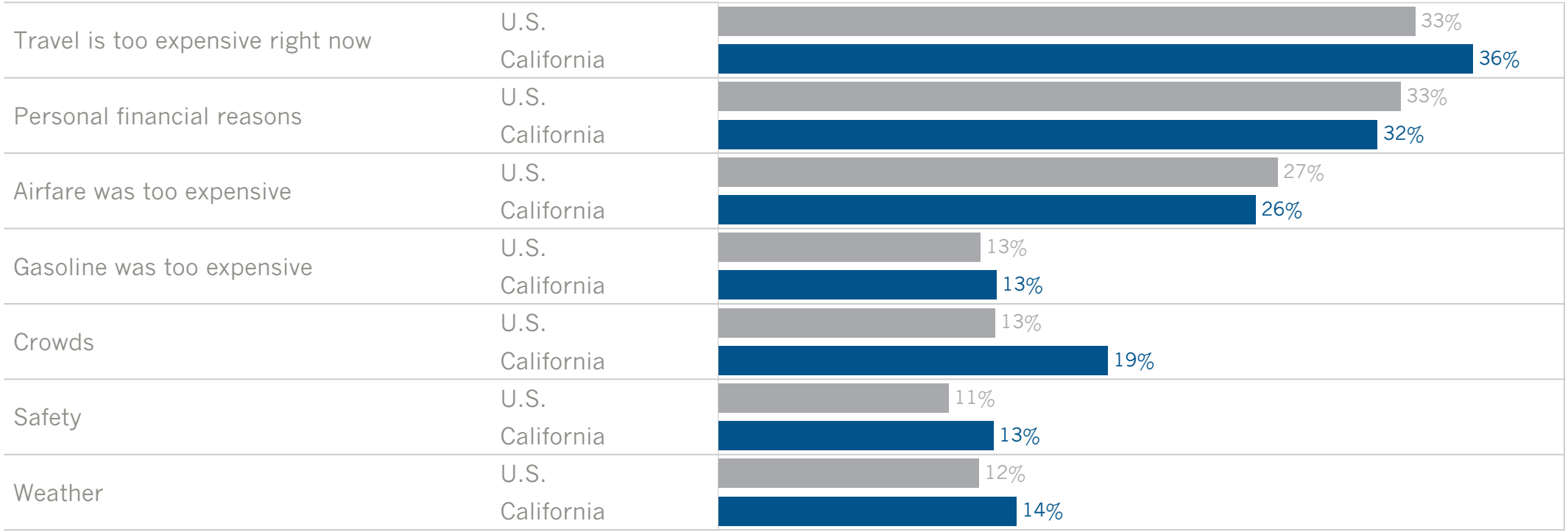
- Travel Deterrents
- Perceptions of Financial Situation
- Travel as a Budget Priority
- Excitement for Travel
- International Travel Intent

U.S. & California Travel Deterrents

The chart below shows travel deterrents among U.S. and California traveling consumers in the past 6 months.

Travel Deterrents (January 2026)

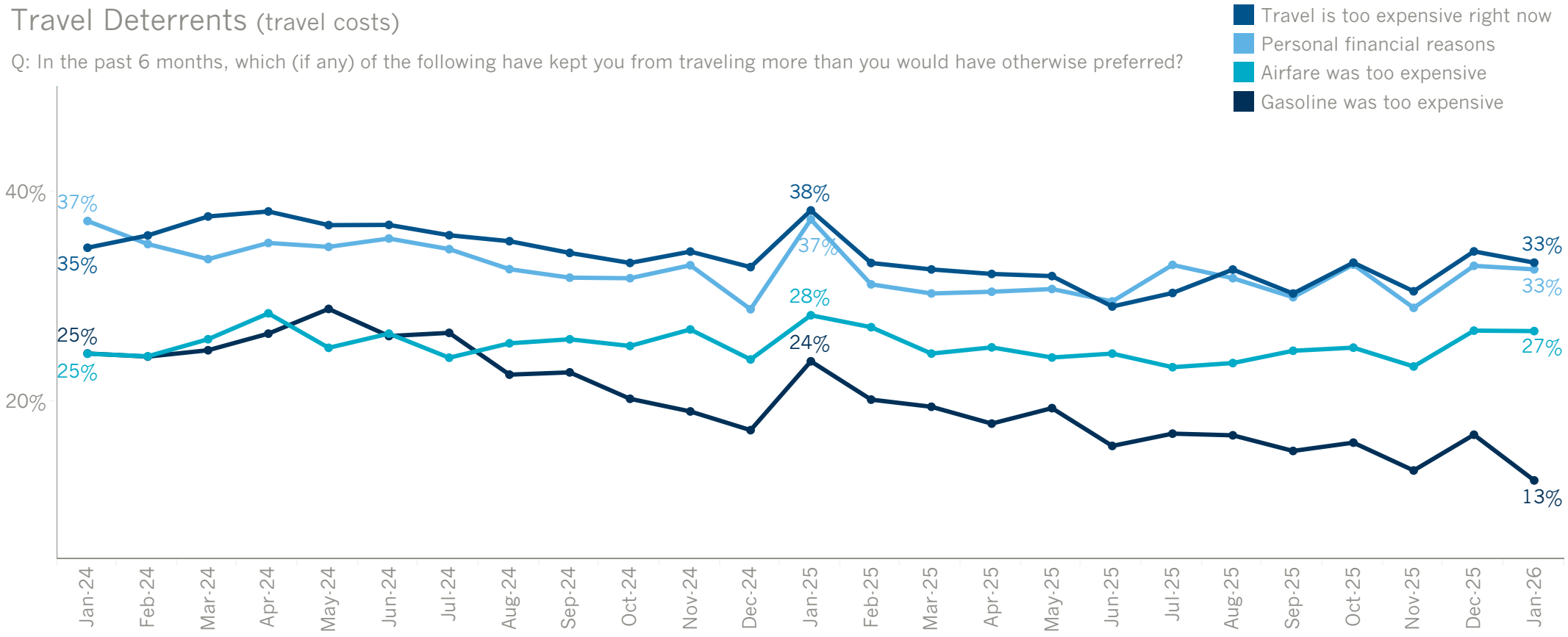
Q: In the past 6 months, which (if any) of the following have kept you from traveling more than you would have otherwise preferred?



Source: Future Partners, *The State of the American Traveler*

U.S. Travel Deterrents- Travel Costs

The chart below shows travel deterrents among U.S. traveling consumers in the past 6 months.



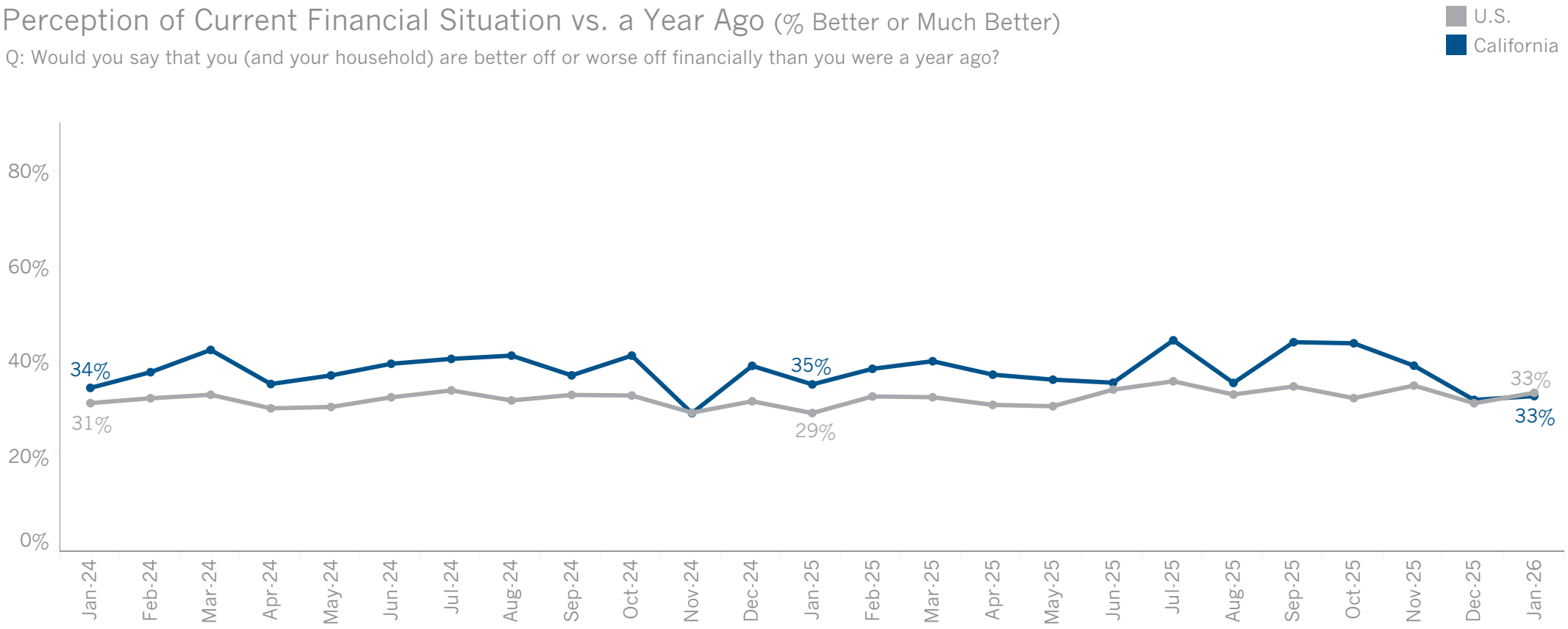
Source: Future Partners, *The State of the American Traveler*

U.S. & California Current Financial Situation

The chart below shows perception of current financial situation (vs. a year ago) among U.S. and California traveling consumers.

Perception of Current Financial Situation vs. a Year Ago (% Better or Much Better)

Q: Would you say that you (and your household) are better off or worse off financially than you were a year ago?



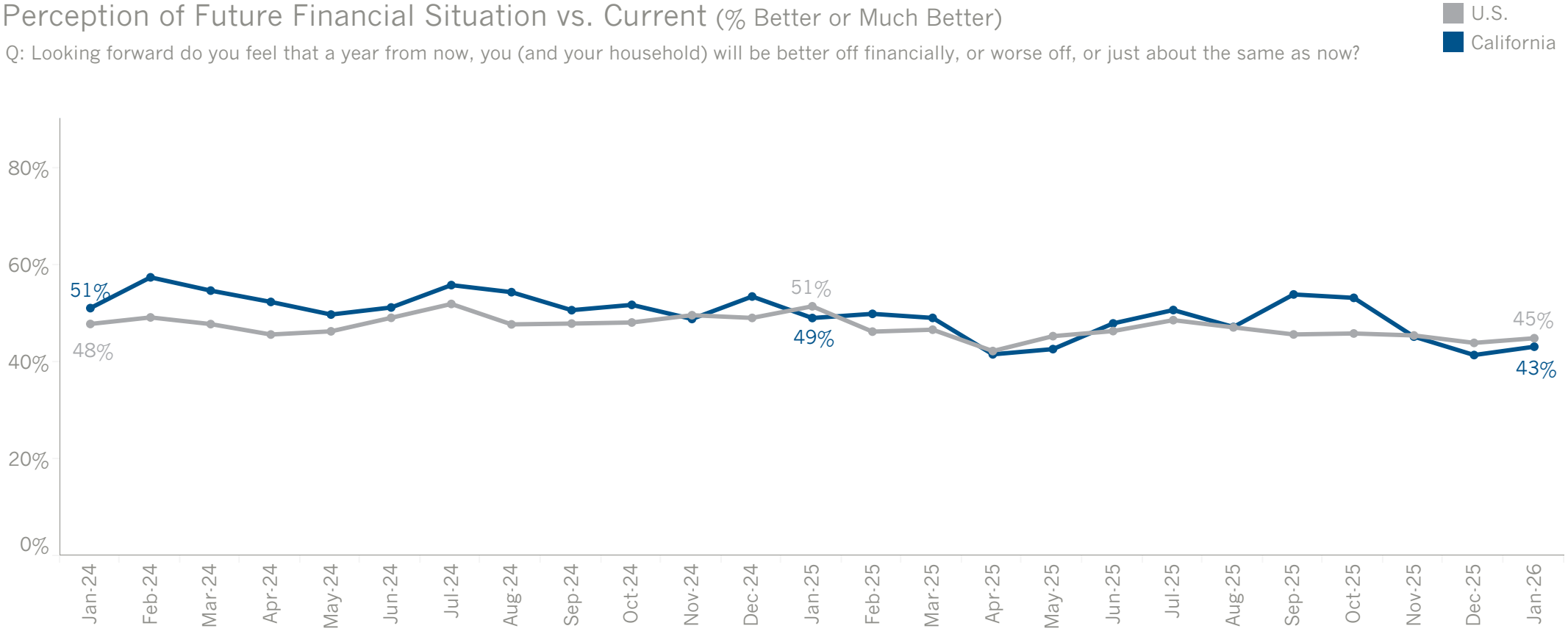
Source: Future Partners, *The State of the American Traveler*

U.S. & California Future Financial Situation

The chart below shows perception of future financial situation among U.S. and California traveling consumers.

Perception of Future Financial Situation vs. Current (% Better or Much Better)

Q: Looking forward do you feel that a year from now, you (and your household) will be better off financially, or worse off, or just about the same as now?



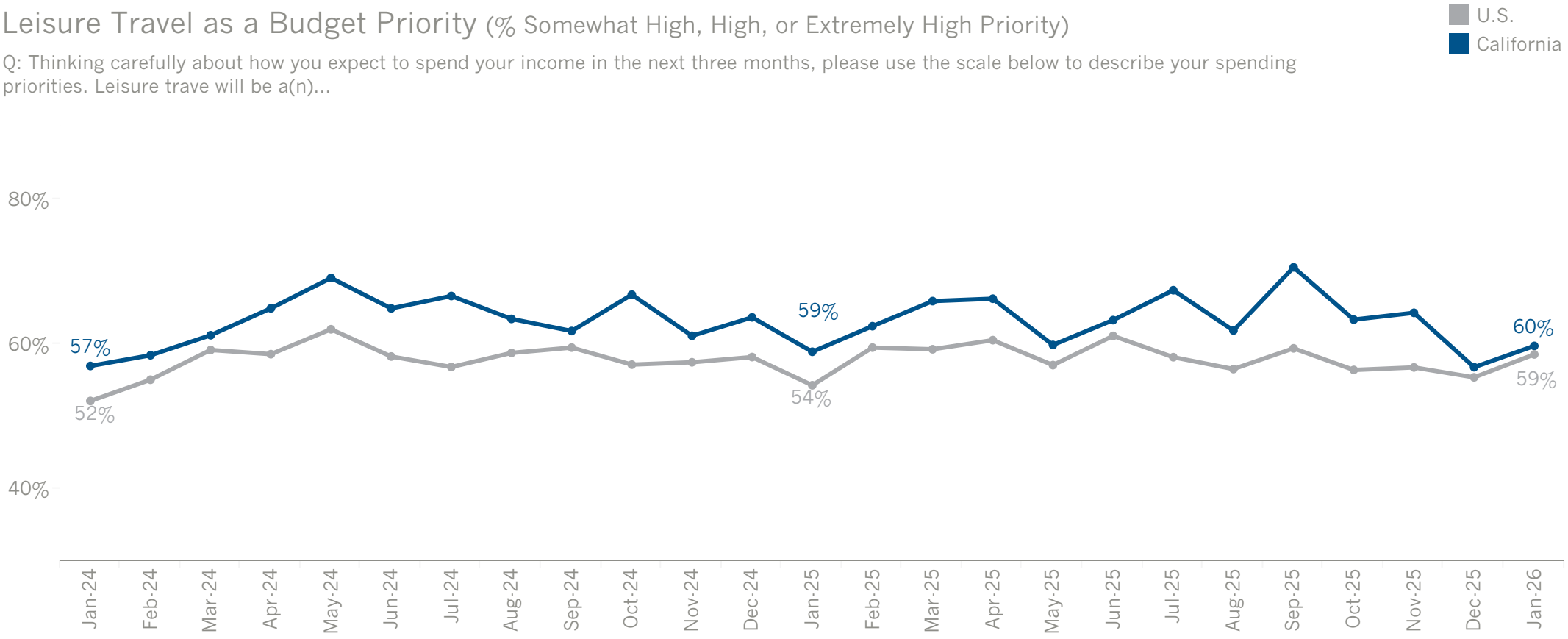
Source: Future Partners, *The State of the American Traveler*

U.S. & California Budget Priorities

The chart below shows perception of leisure travel as a budget priority among U.S. and California traveling consumers.

Leisure Travel as a Budget Priority (% Somewhat High, High, or Extremely High Priority)

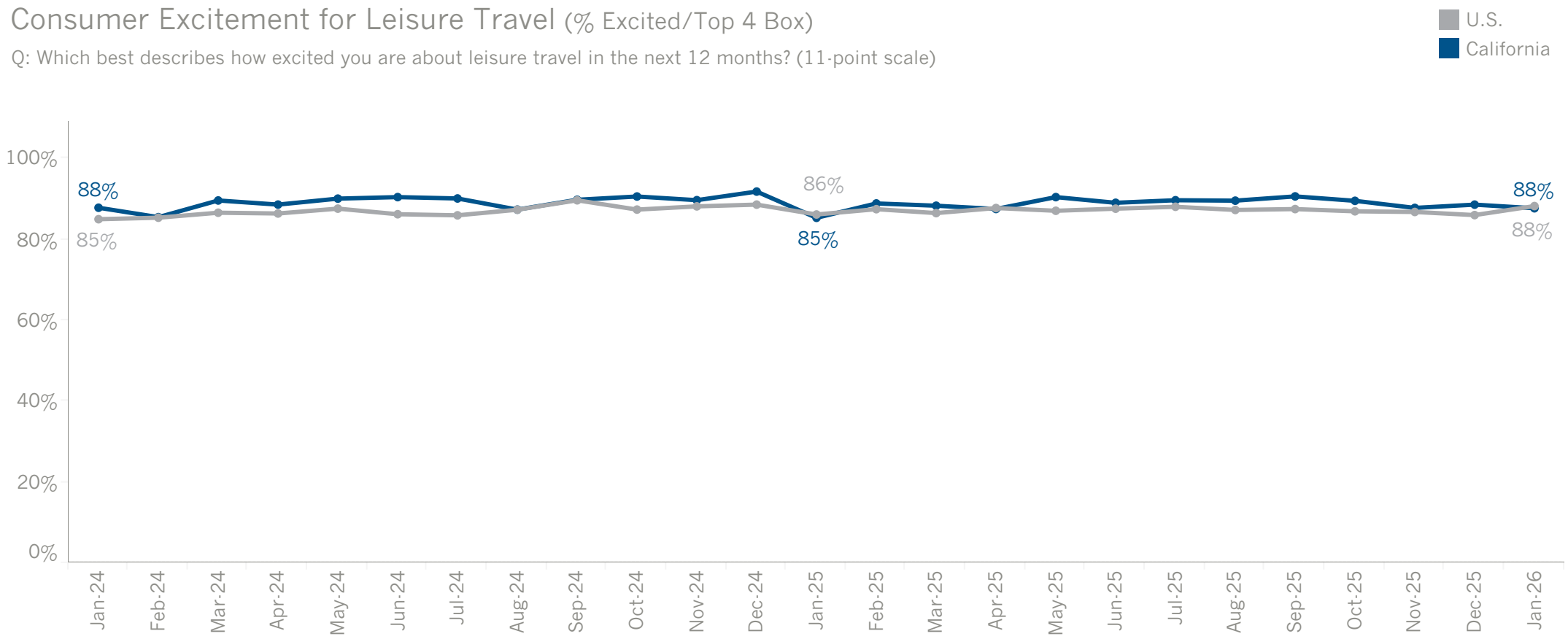
Q: Thinking carefully about how you expect to spend your income in the next three months, please use the scale below to describe your spending priorities. Leisure trave will be a(n)...



Source: Future Partners, *The State of the American Traveler*

U.S. & California Excitement for Travel

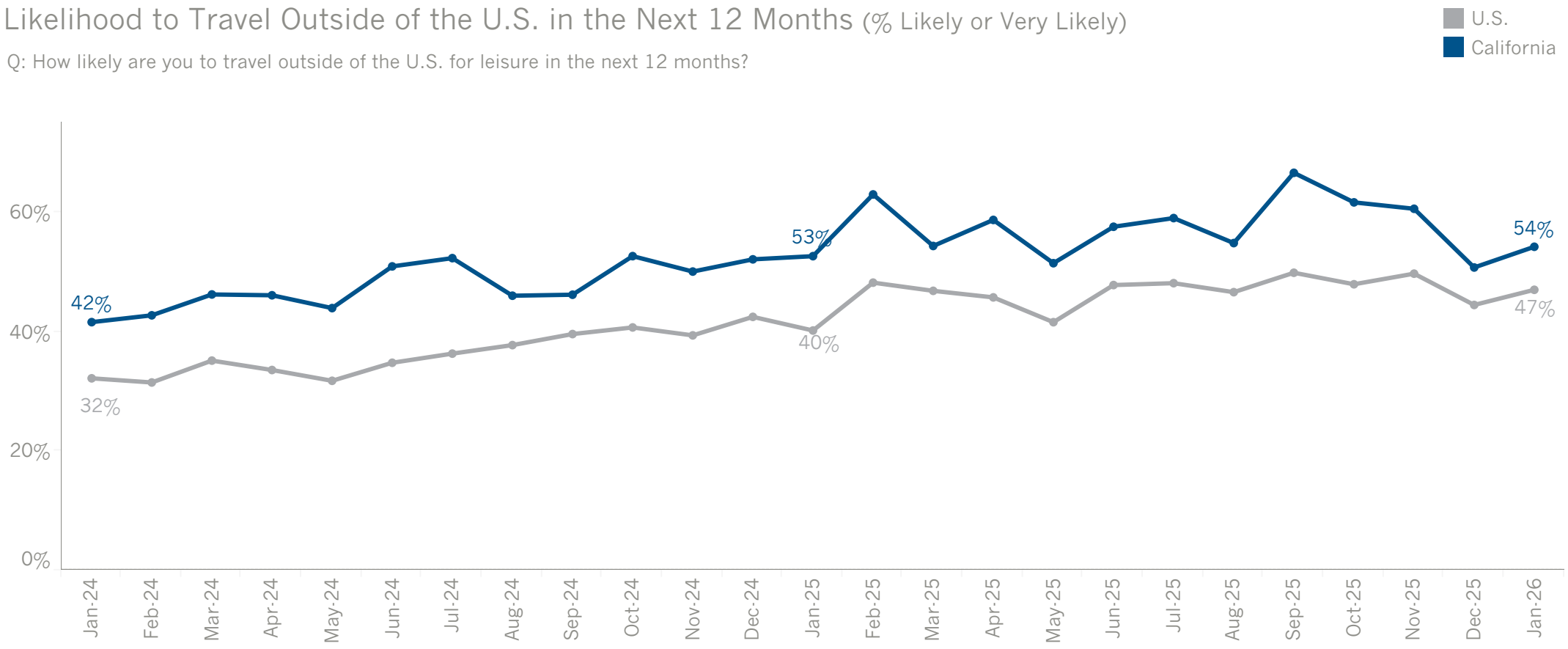
The chart below shows consumer excitement to travel in the next 12 months among U.S. and California traveling consumers.



Source: Future Partners, *The State of the American Traveler*

U.S. & California Int'l Leisure Travel Plans

The chart below shows consumer intent to travel outside the U.S. in the next 12 months among U.S. and California traveling consumers.



Source: Future Partners, *The State of the American Traveler*

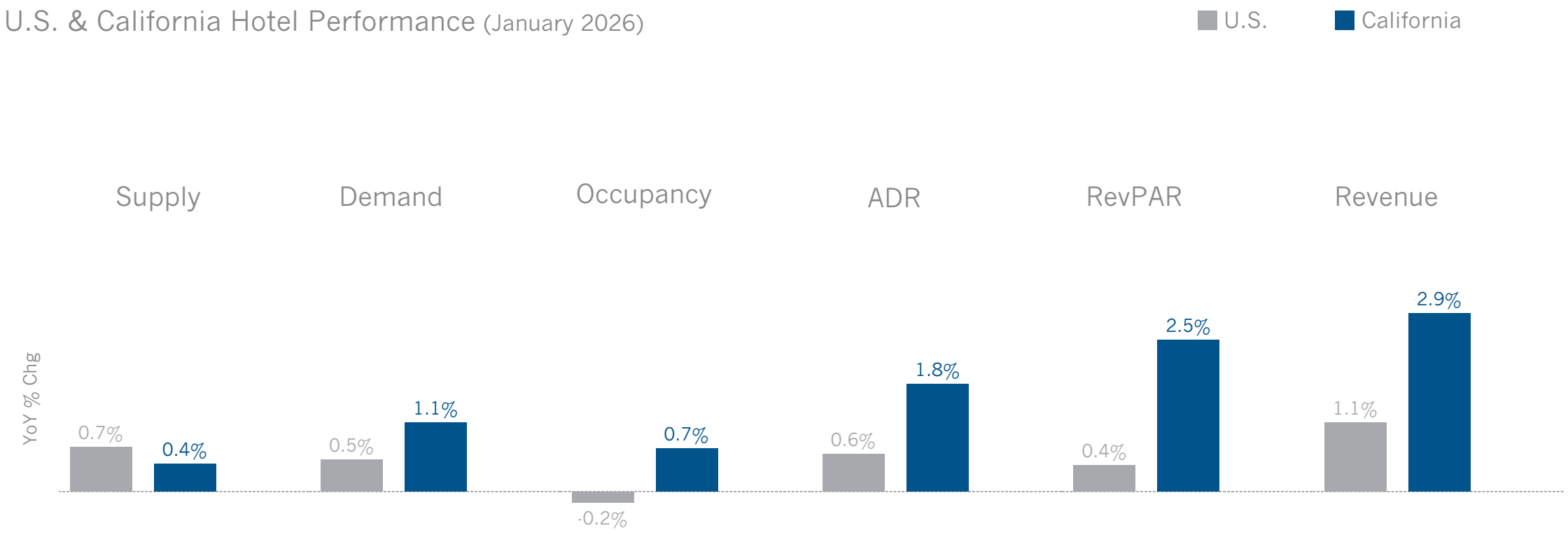
Domestic Indicators:

Lodging

- Room Demand & Revenue
- Monthly Hotel Performance Metrics
- Group Room Demand & Revenue
- Short Term Rental Performance Metrics

U.S. & California Hotel Performance

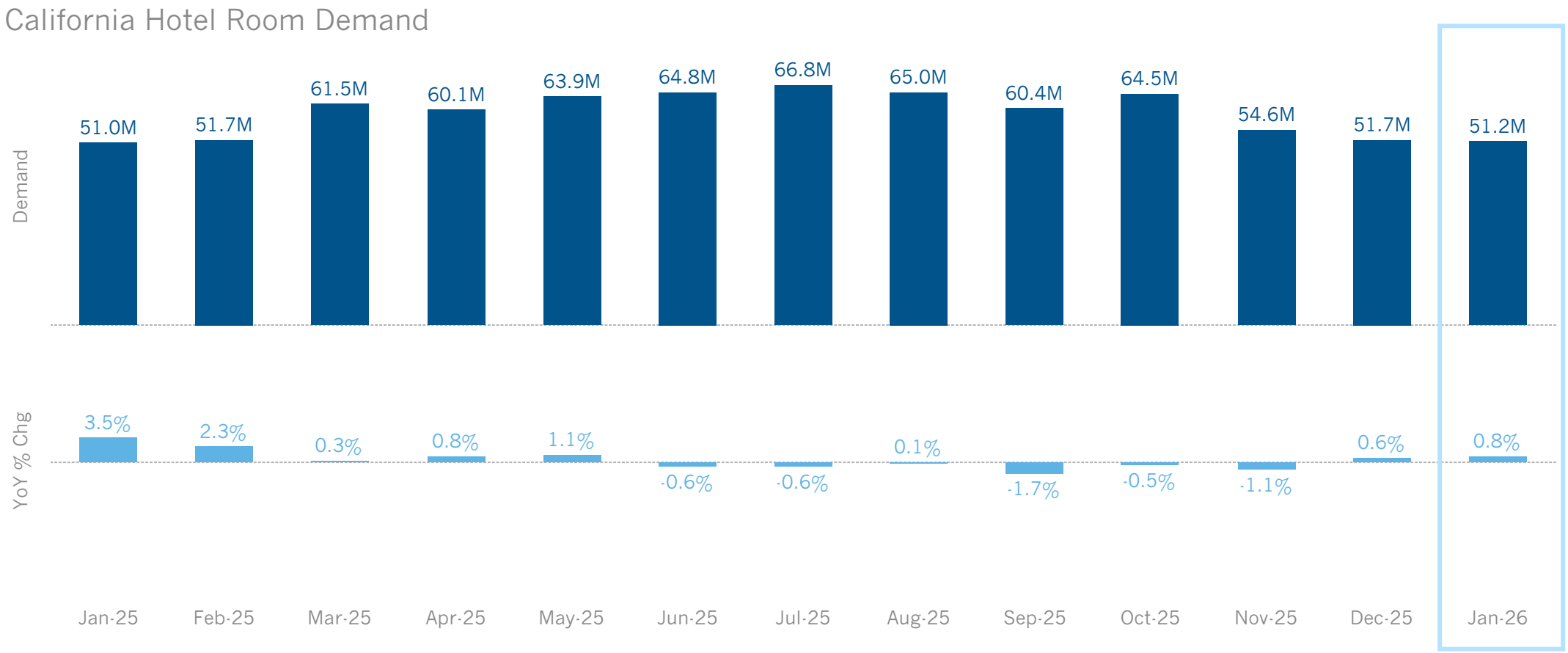
The chart below shows year-over-year performance for the U.S. and California for the reporting month.



Source: CoStar

California Hotel Room Demand

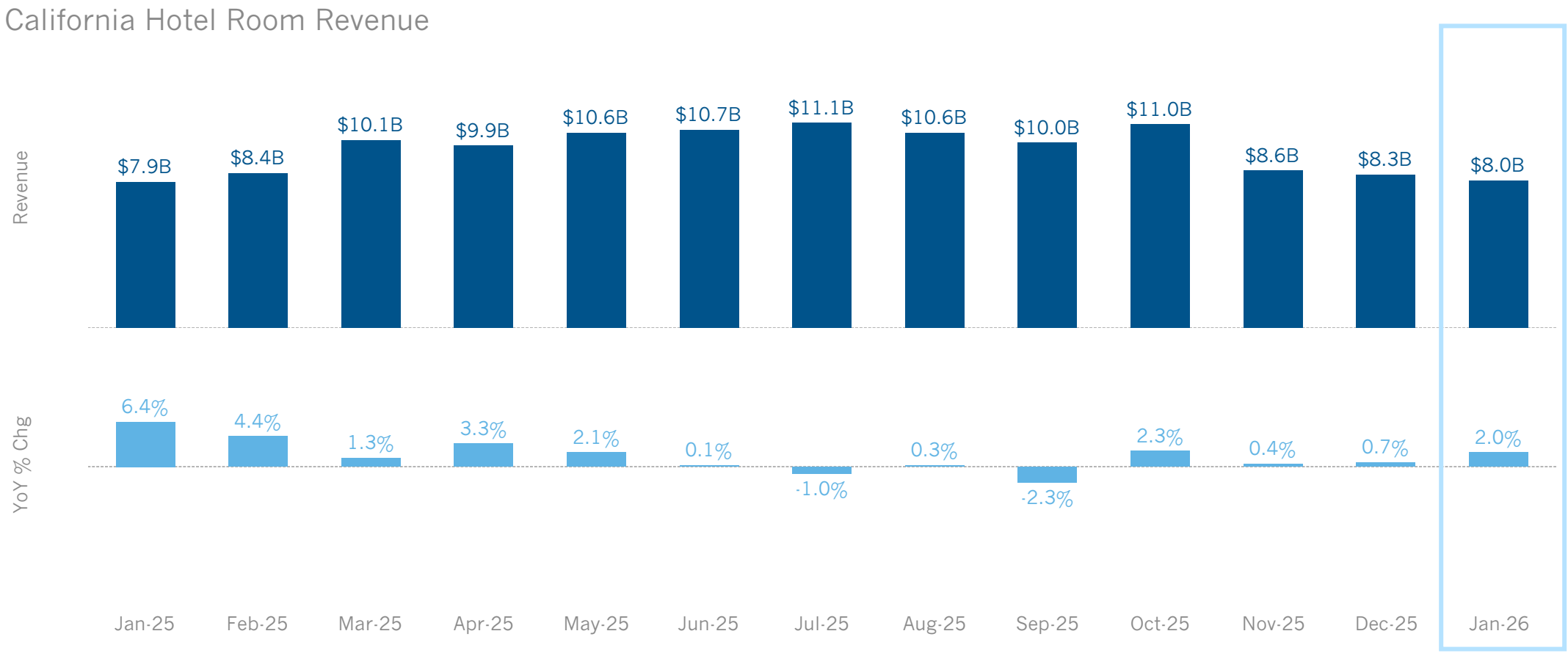
The chart below shows monthly California hotel room demand and percent change.



Source: CoStar

California Hotel Room Revenue

The chart below shows monthly California hotel room revenue and percent change.

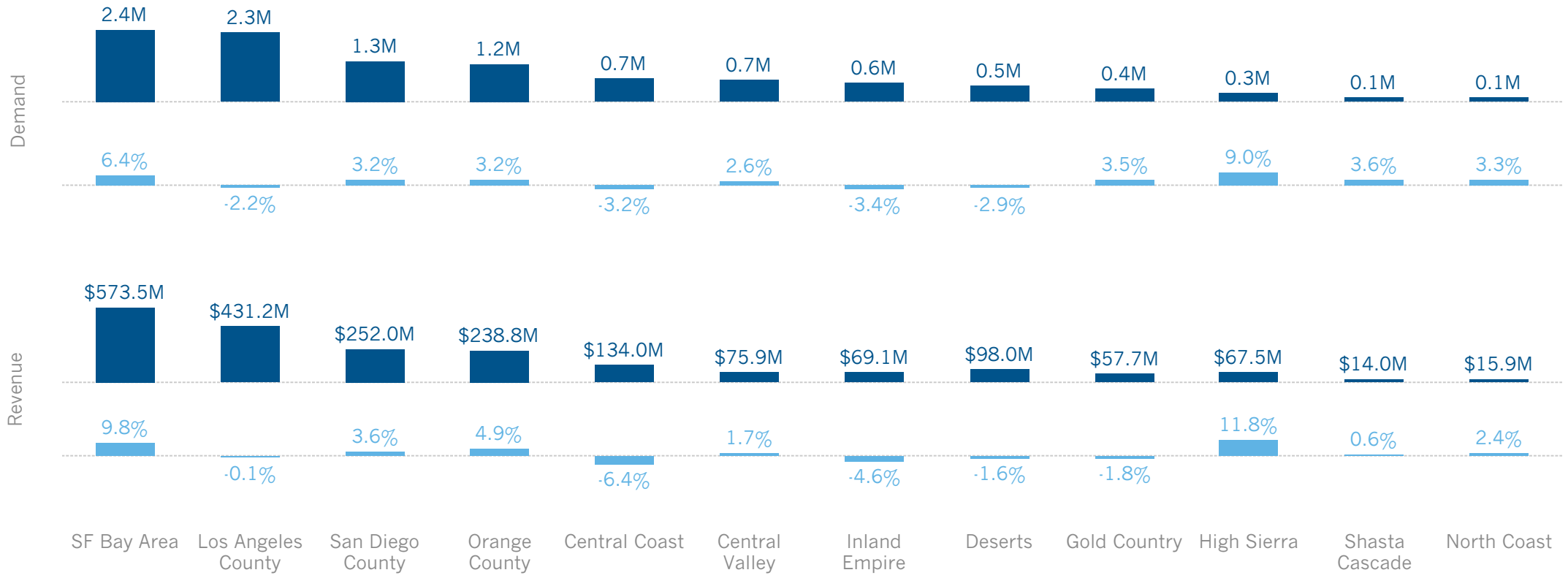


Source: CoStar

Regional Hotel Room Demand & Revenue

The charts below show regional hotel room demand and revenue percent change to prior year for the reporting month.

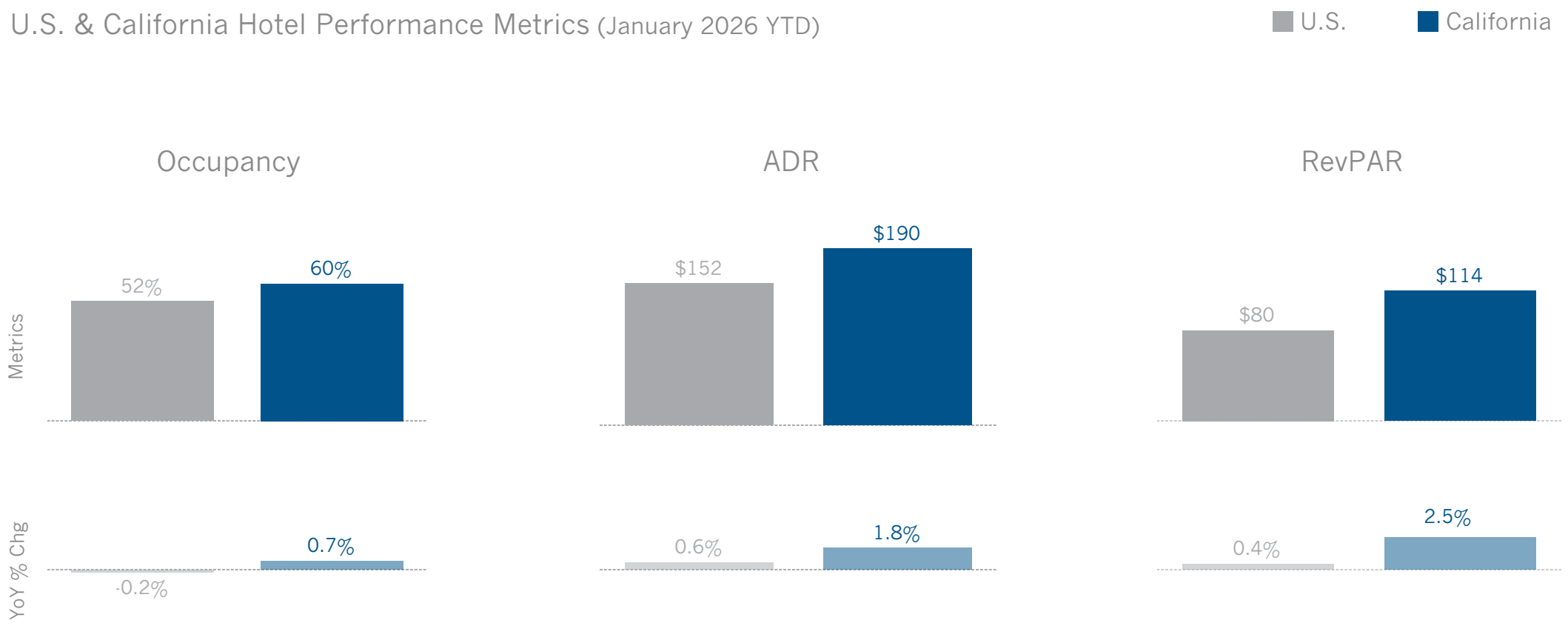
California Regional Hotel Room Demand & Revenue (January 2026)



Source: CoStar

U.S. & California Hotel Performance Metrics

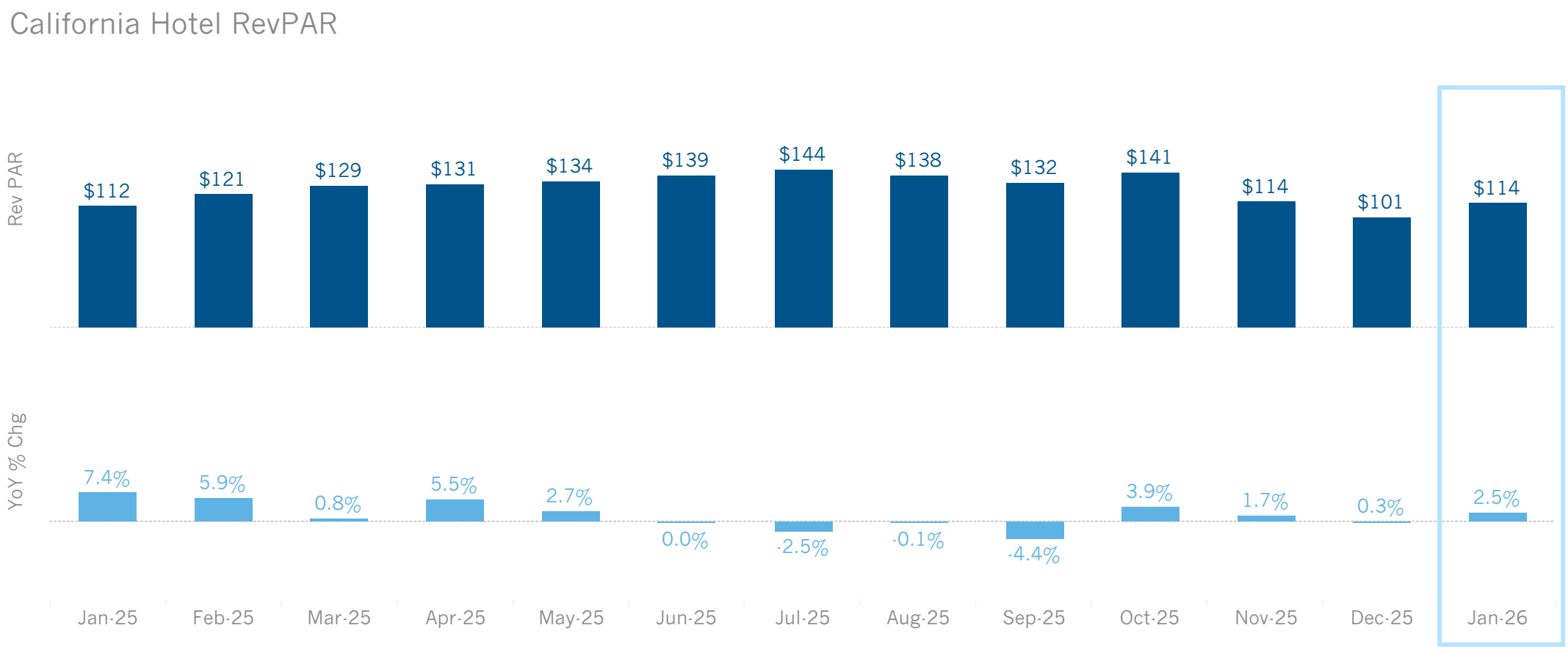
The charts below show key hotel metrics and percent change for the U.S. and California for the reporting month.



Source: CoStar

California Hotel RevPAR

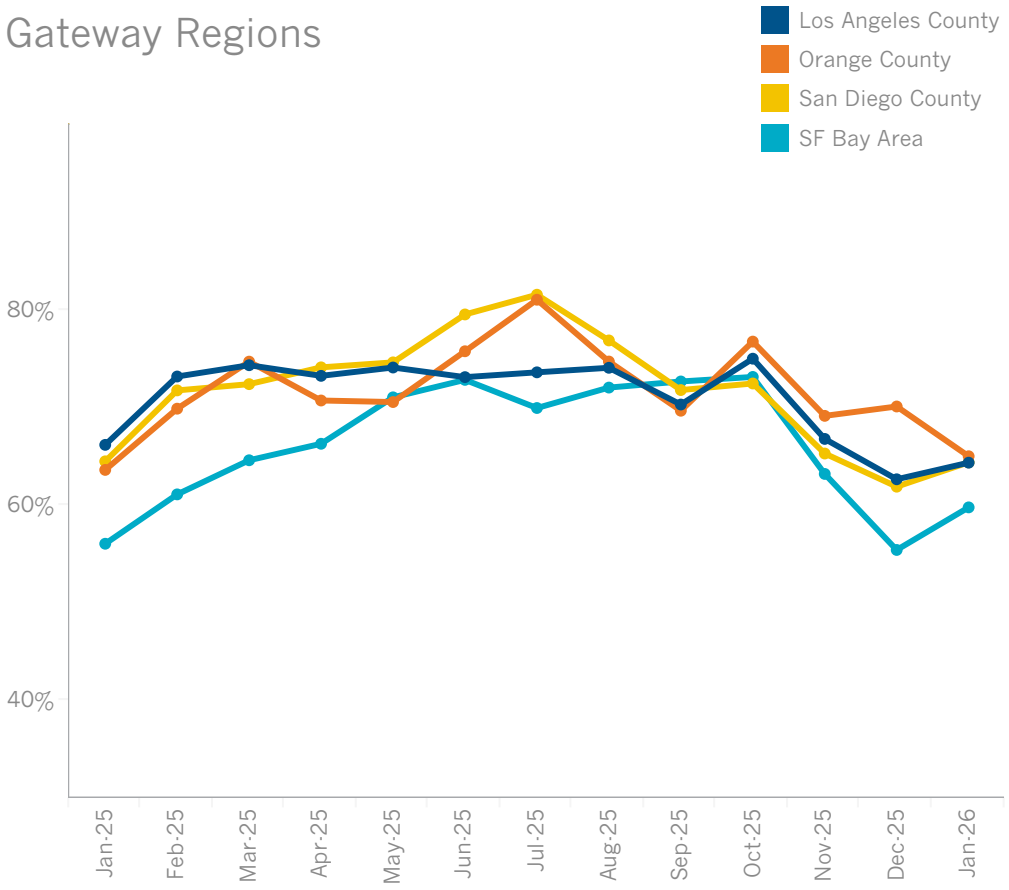
The chart below shows monthly California hotel revenue per available room (RevPAR) and percent change.

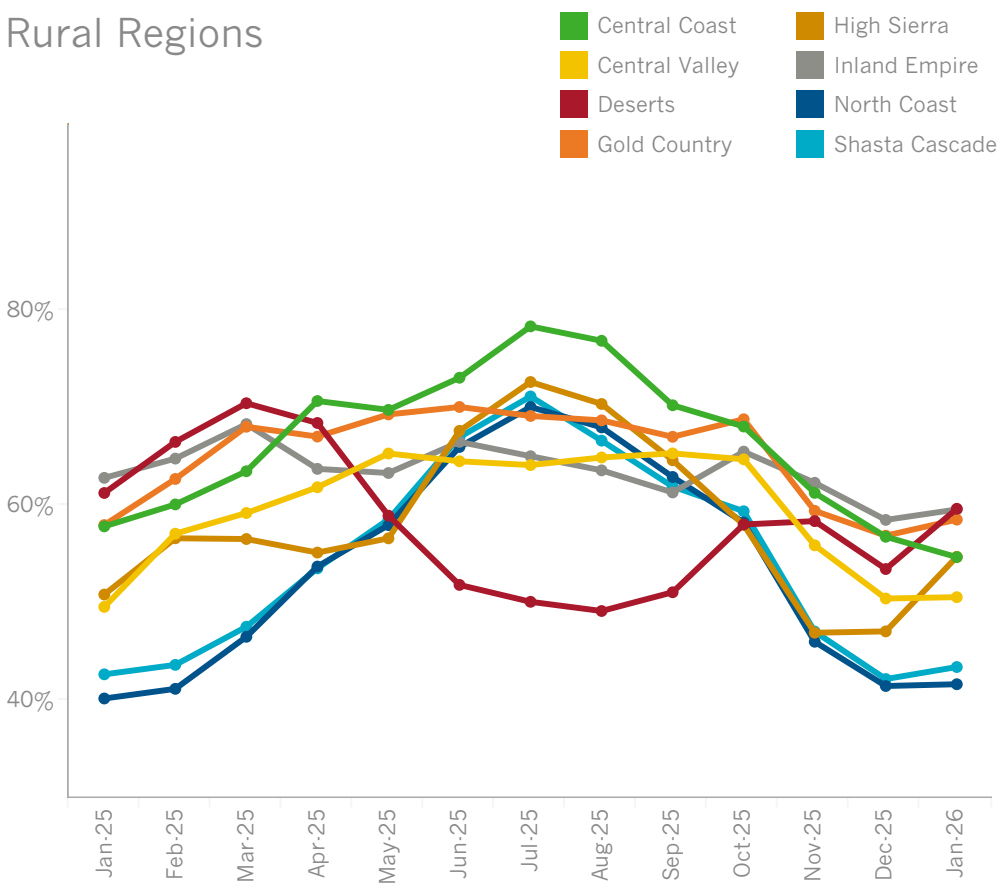


Source: CoStar

California Regional Hotel Occupancy

The charts below show monthly occupancy rates for gateway and rural tourism regions.



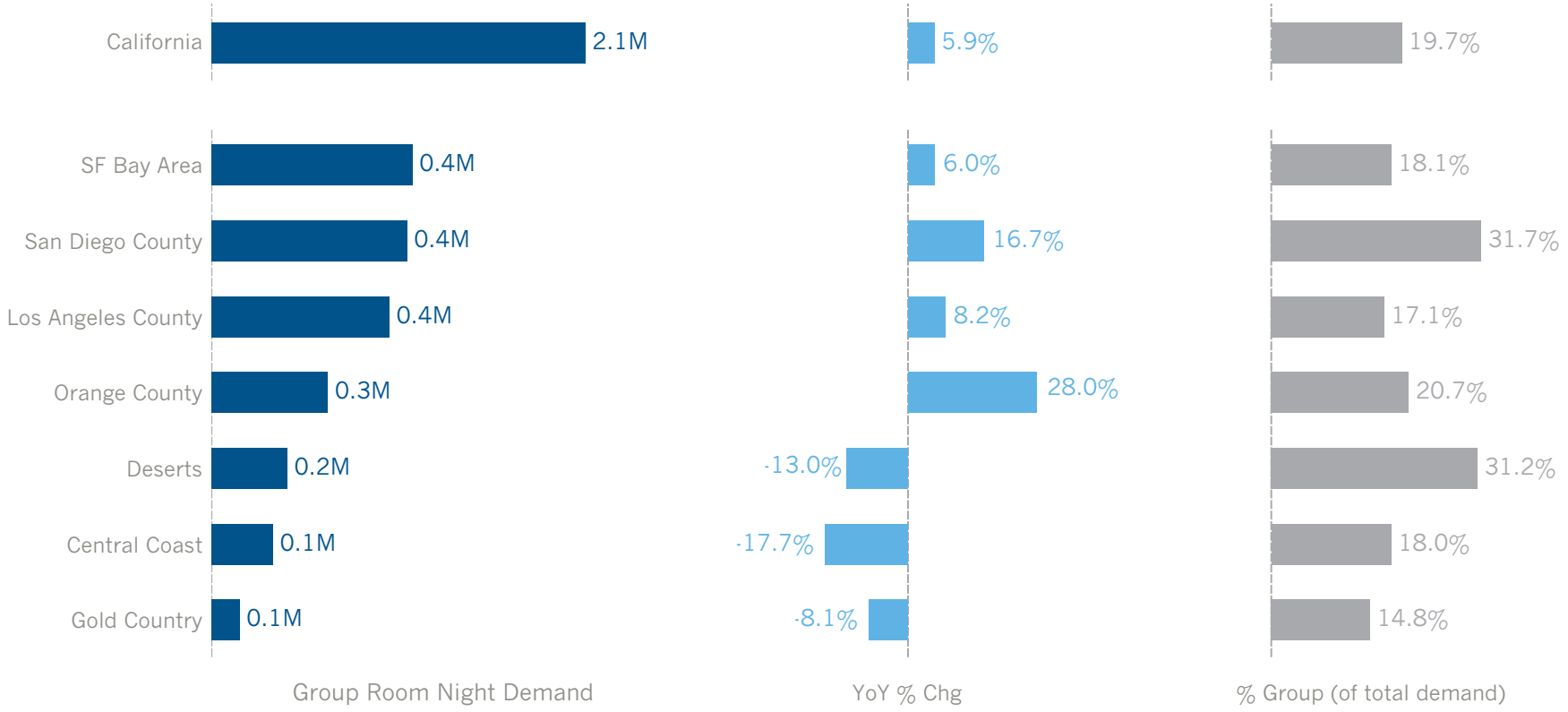


Source: CoStar

California Hotel Group Demand

The chart below shows group room demand by market for the reporting month, percent change, & percent of total demand.

California & Regional Hotel Group Room Night Demand (January 2026)

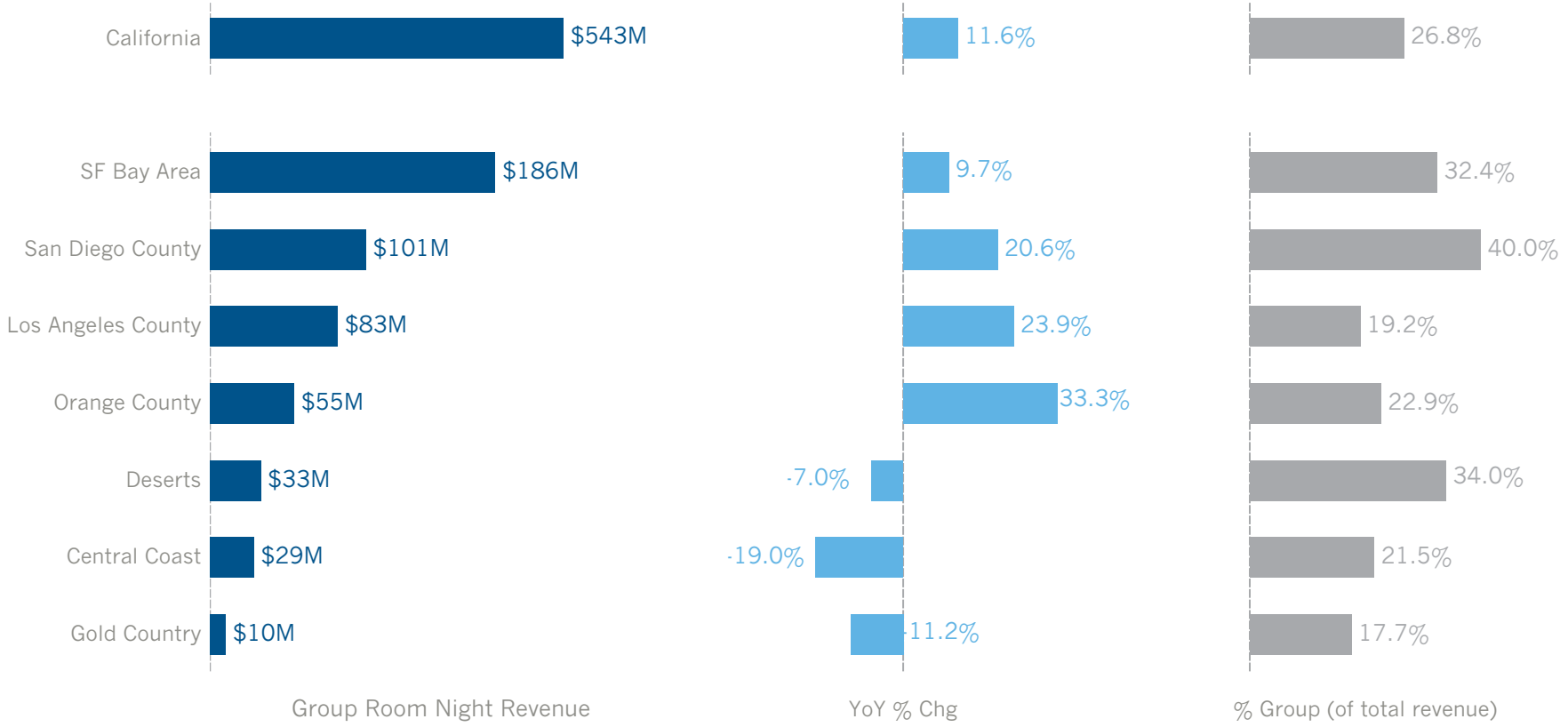


Source: CoStar

California Hotel Group Revenue

The chart below shows group room revenue by market for the reporting month, percent change, & percent of total demand.

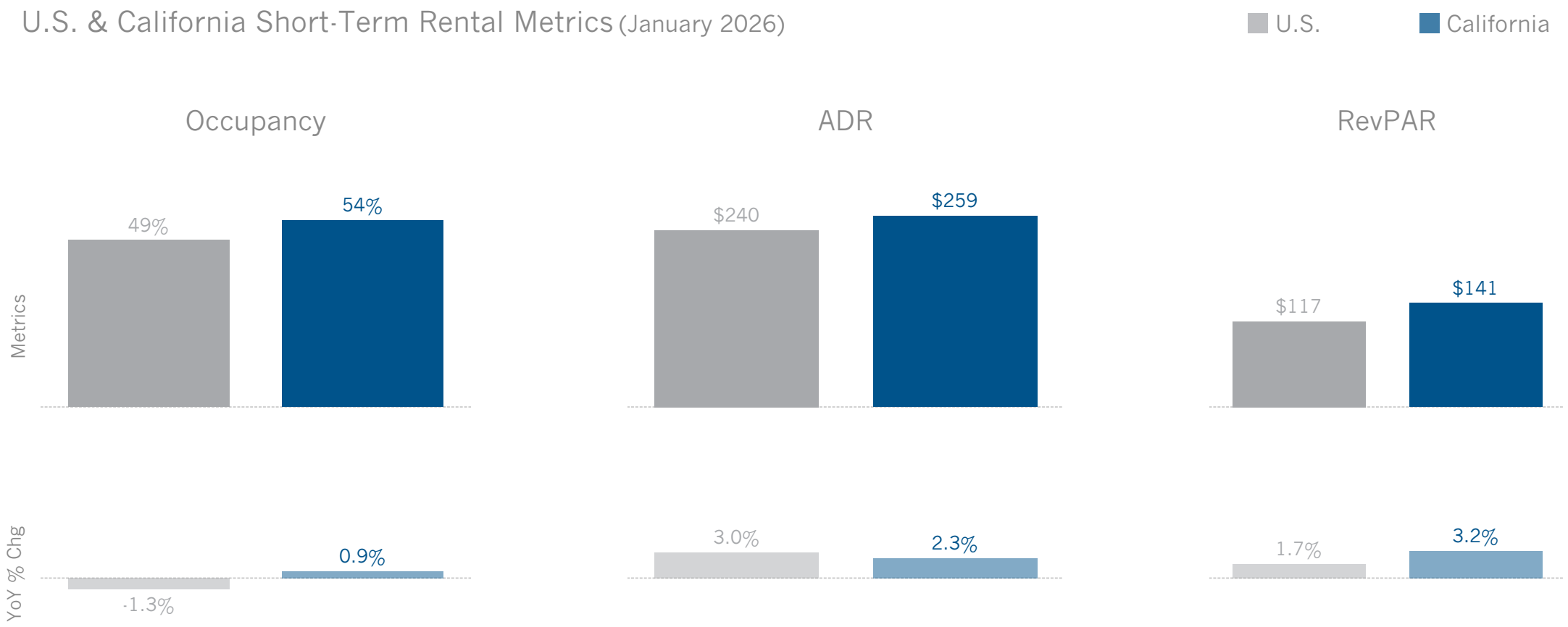
California & Regional Hotel Group Room Night Revenue (January 2026)



Source: CoStar

California Short-Term Rental Metrics

The chart below shows key short-term rental metrics and percent change for the U.S. and California for the reporting month.



Source: AirDNA

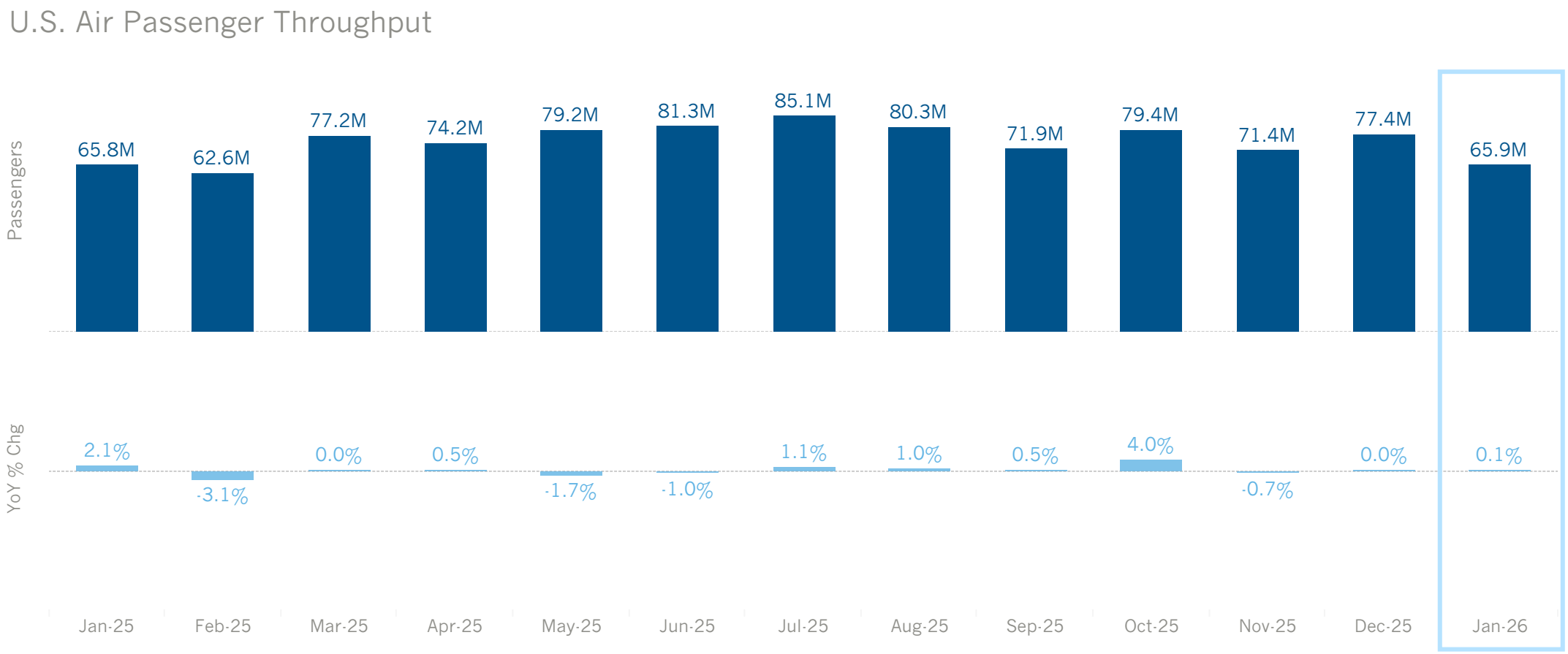
Domestic Indicators:

Airlift

- Air Passenger Throughput
- Domestic Non-Stop Seats

U.S. Air Passenger Throughput

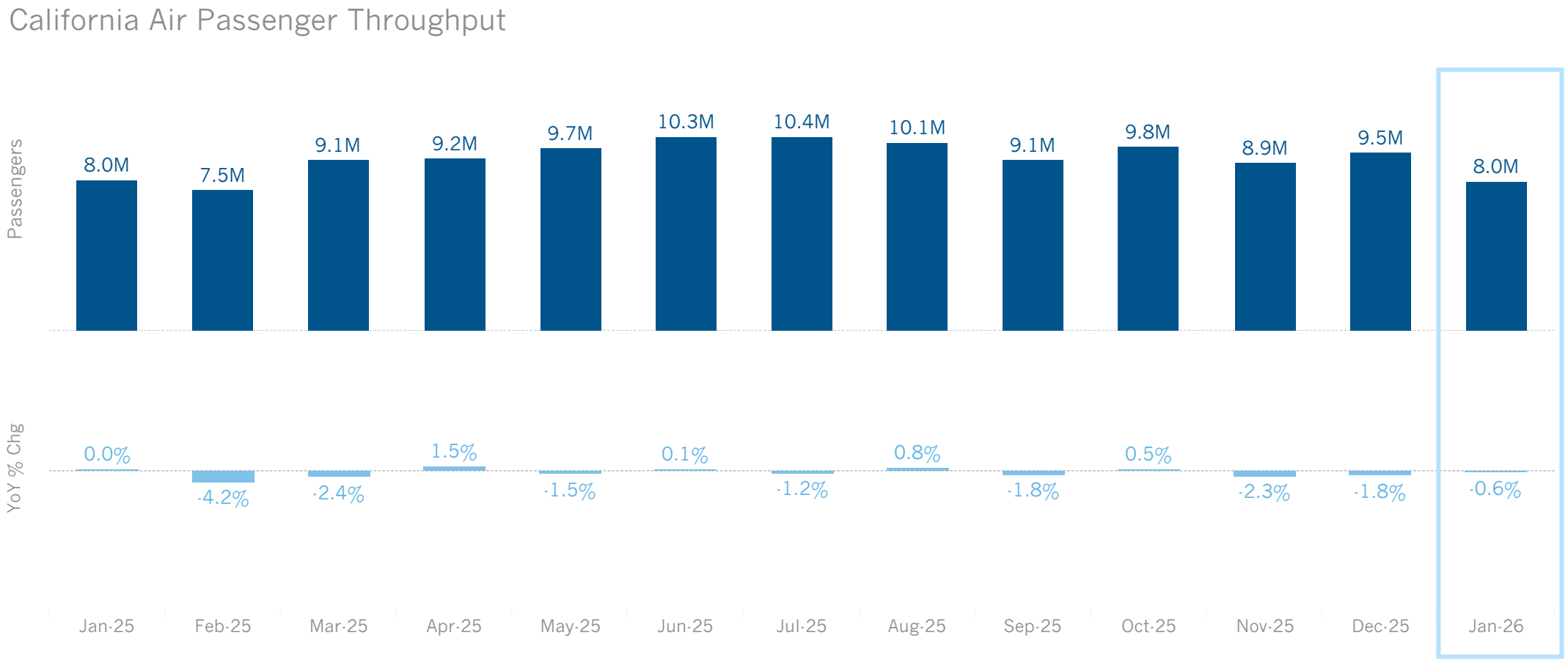
The chart below shows the monthly total number of passengers screened at TSA checkpoints in U.S. airports and percent change.



Source: Department of Homeland Security (DHS)

California Air Passenger Throughput

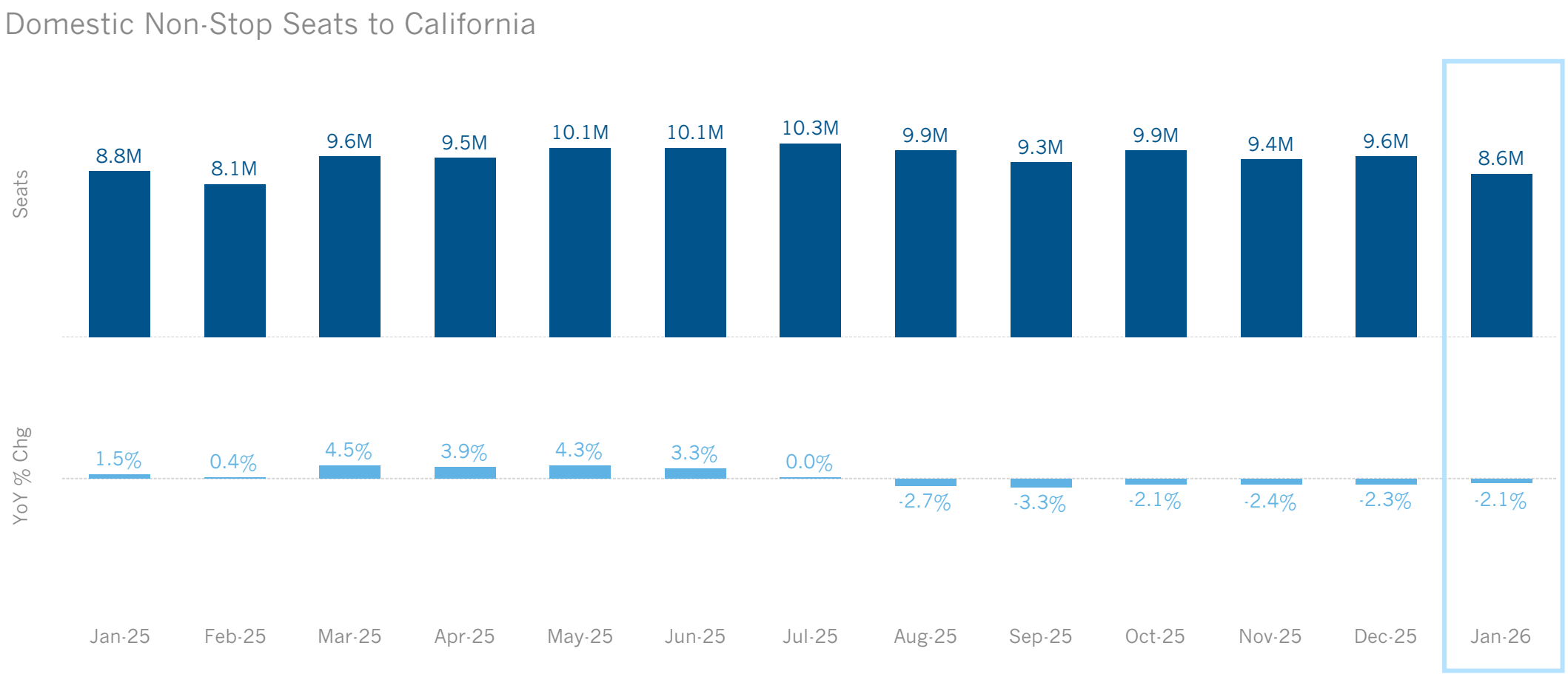
The chart below shows the monthly total number of passengers screened at TSA checkpoints in California airports and percent change.



Source: Department of Homeland Security (DHS)

Domestic Non-Stop Seats

The chart below shows monthly domestic non-stop seats to California and percent change.



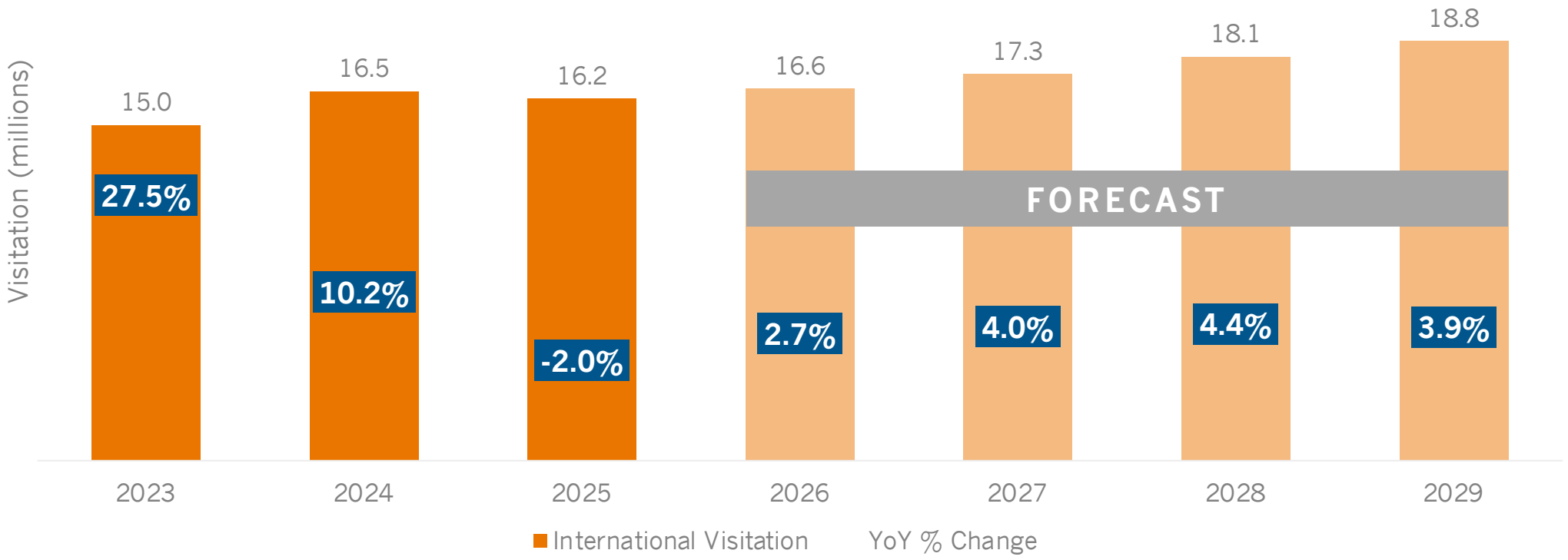
Source: Cirium

International Indicators: Forecast

- International Market Forecast

California International Visitation Forecast

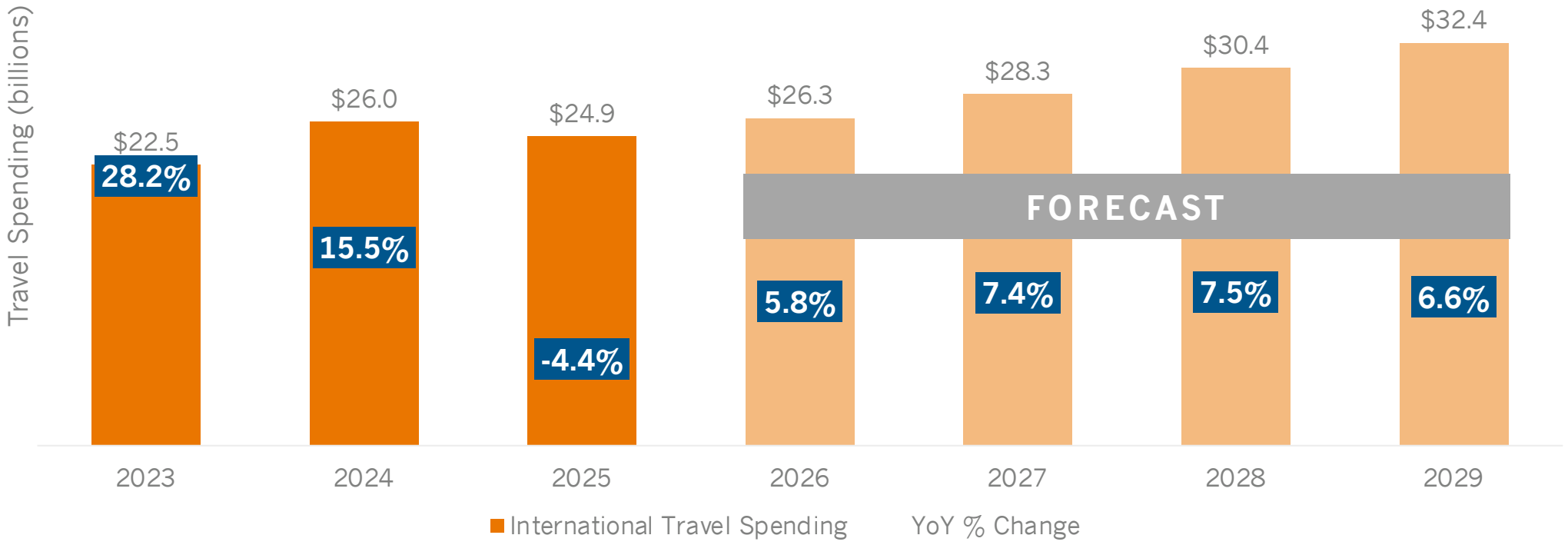
The chart below shows the current international visitation forecast and annual growth rate.



Source: Tourism Economics (Feb 2026)

California International Spending Forecast

The chart below shows the current travel international spending forecast and annual growth rate.

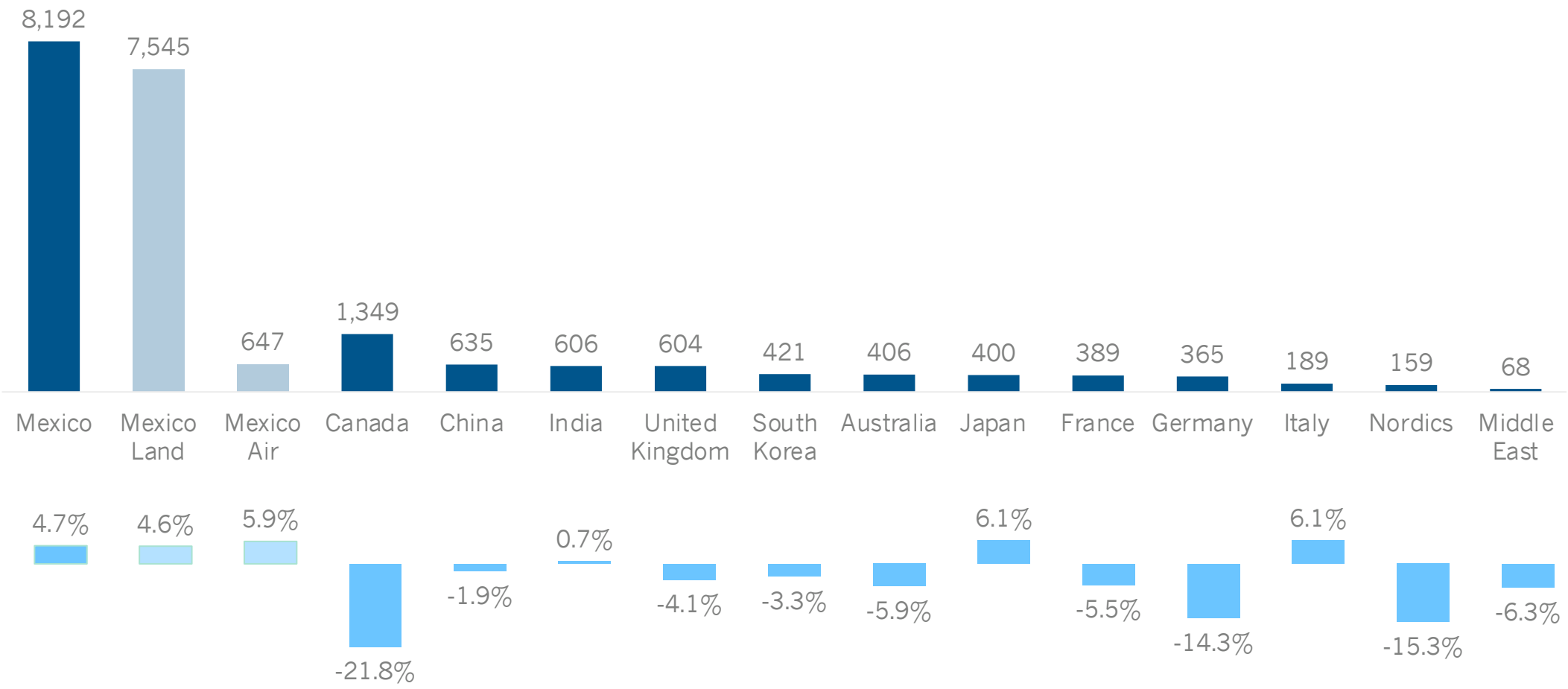


Source: Tourism Economics (Feb 2026)

Forecast: International Markets (2025)

The table below shows the international visitation forecast for California broken out by international market.

2025 Visitation Forecast (Thousands) and YoY % Change

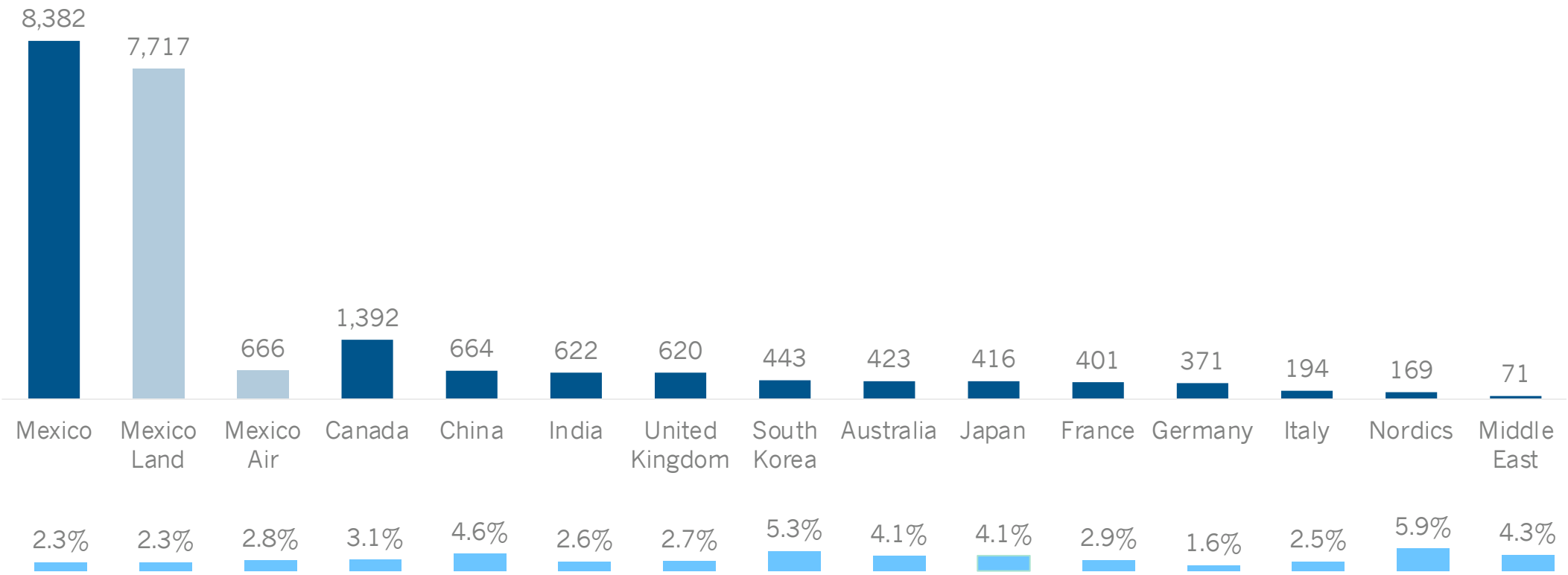


Source: Tourism Economics (Feb 2026)

Forecast: International Markets (2026)

The table below shows the international visitation forecast for California broken out by international market.

2026 Visitation Forecast (Thousands) and YoY % Change



Source: Tourism Economics (Feb 2026)

International Indicators:

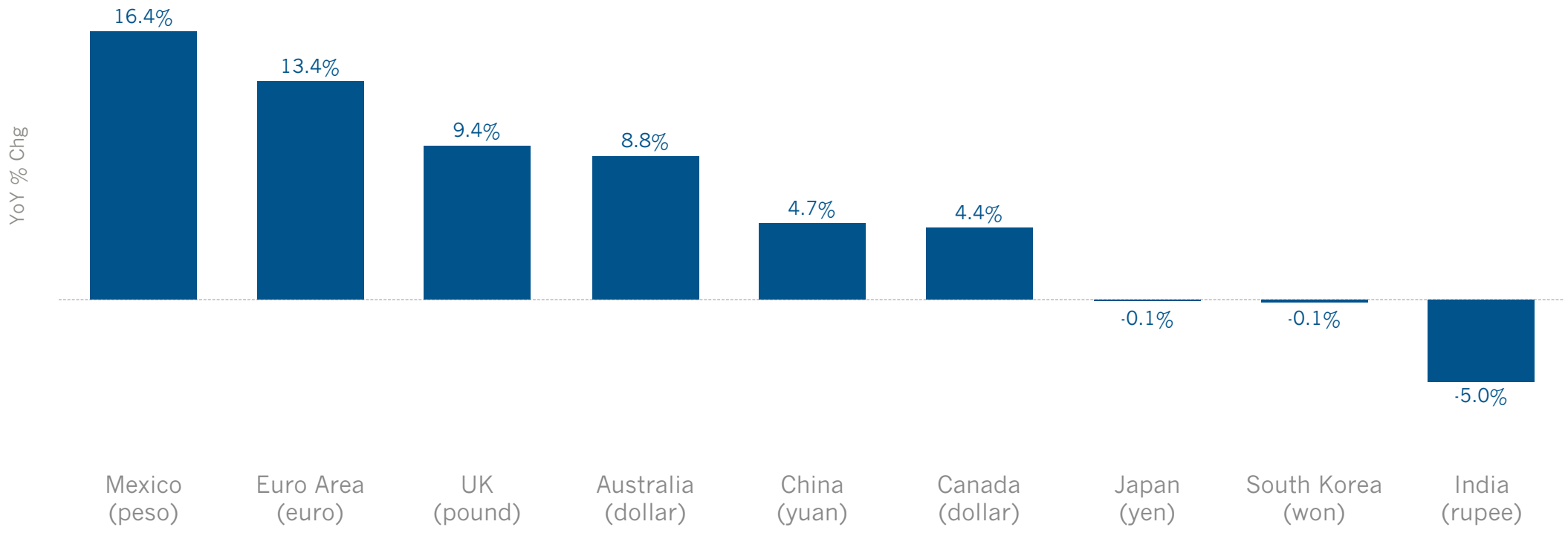
Exchange Rate

- Foreign Currencies to U.S. Dollar

Exchange Rates

The chart below shows the year-over-year change in the exchange rate of the foreign currency to the U.S. dollar.

Change in Exchange Rate to U.S. Dollar (January 2026)



Source: X-Rate

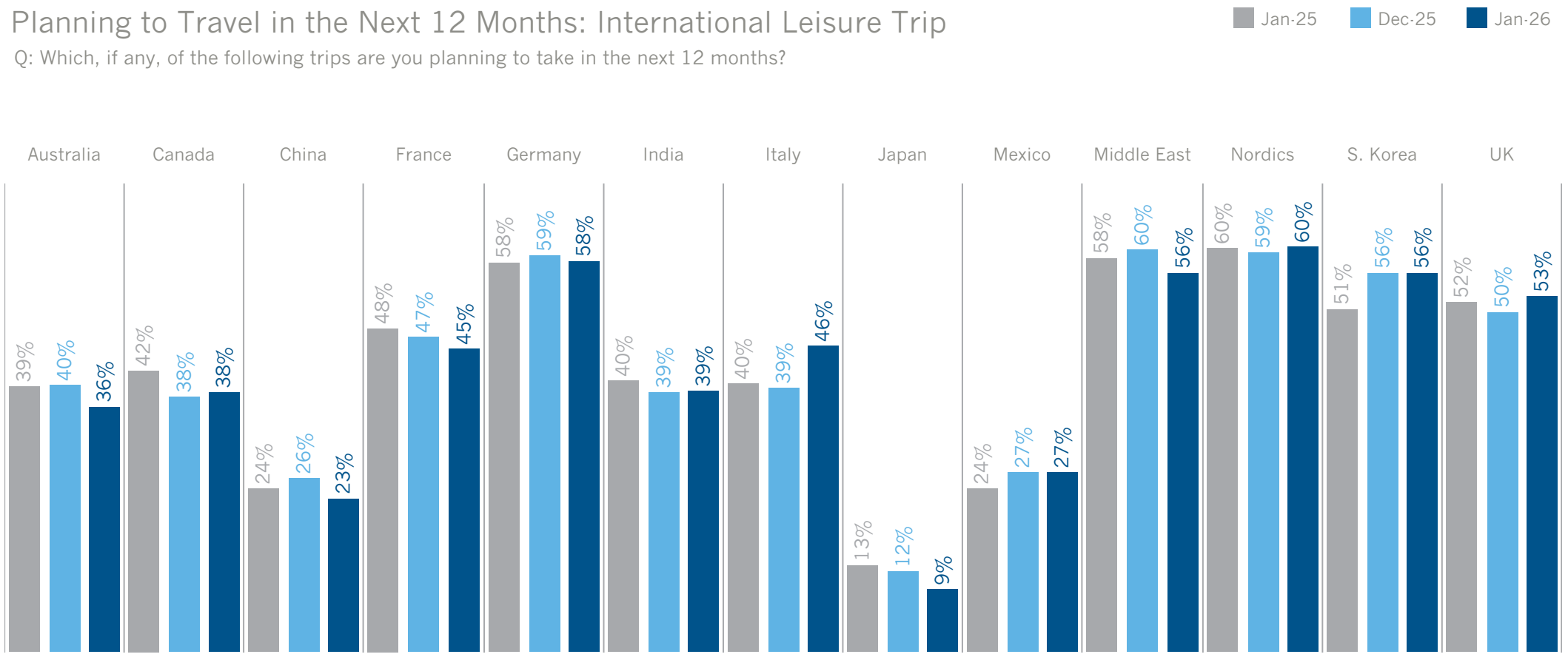
International Indicators:

Consumer Sentiment

- Travel Planned
- Barriers to Travel
- Considering Travel to U.S. & California

Travel Planned (International Leisure)

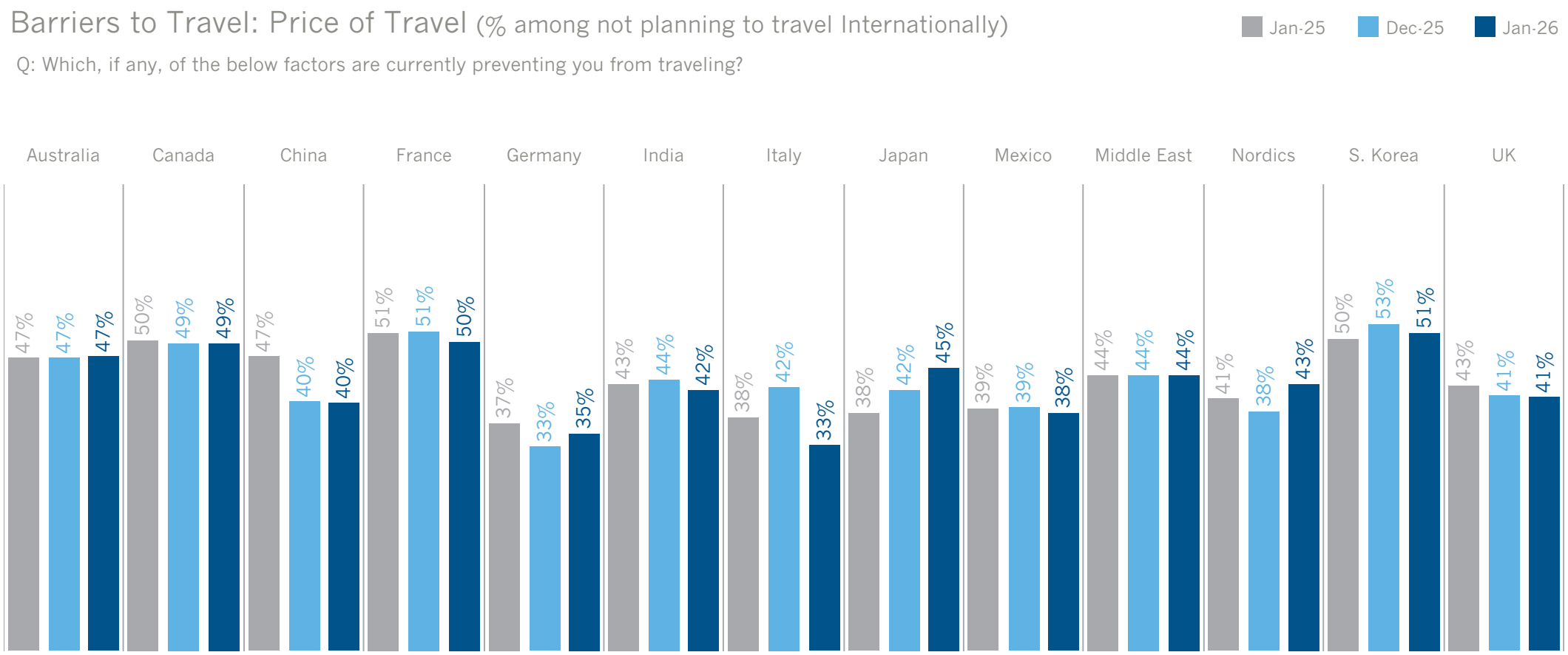
The chart below shows international leisure travel planned in the next 12 months by market.



Source: YouGov

Barriers to Travel (Price)

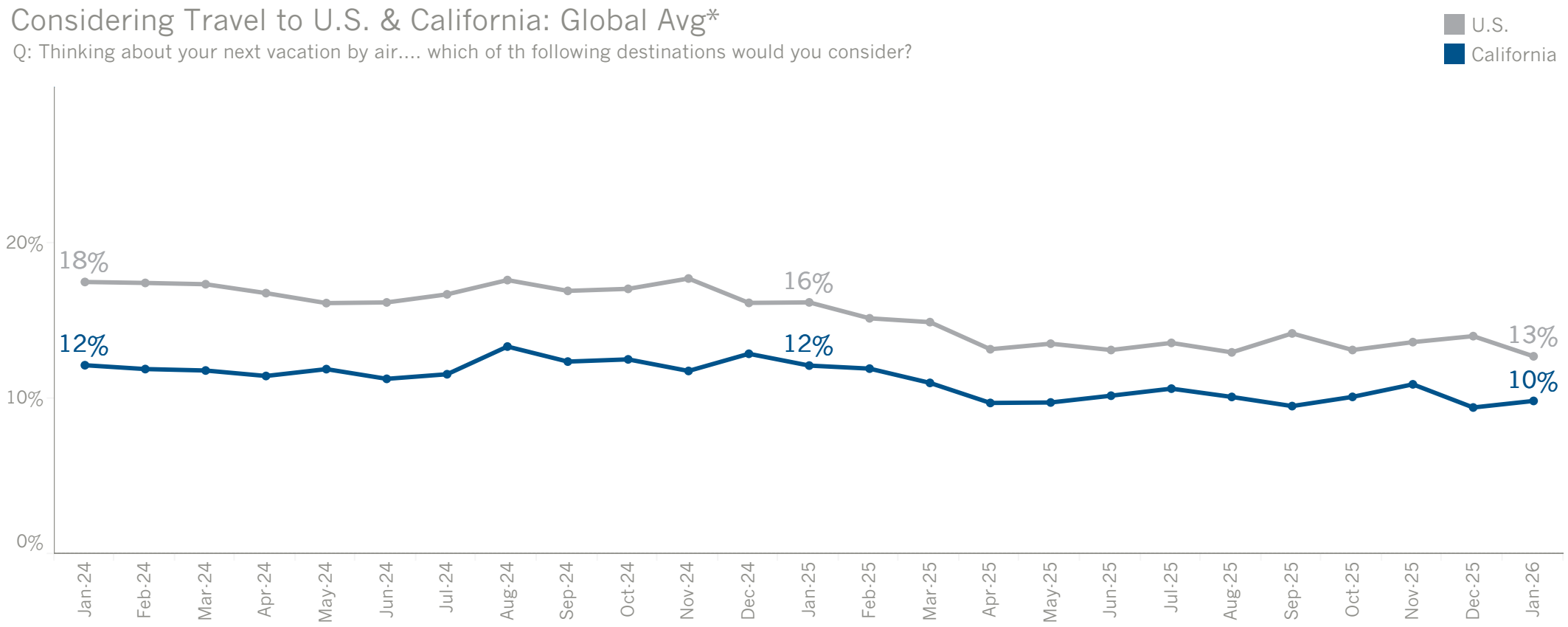
The chart below shows price of travel as a barrier among international consumers not currently planning an international trip.



Source: YouGov

International Markets Considering Travel

The chart below shows the percent of travelers considering travel to the U.S. and California in the next 12 months.

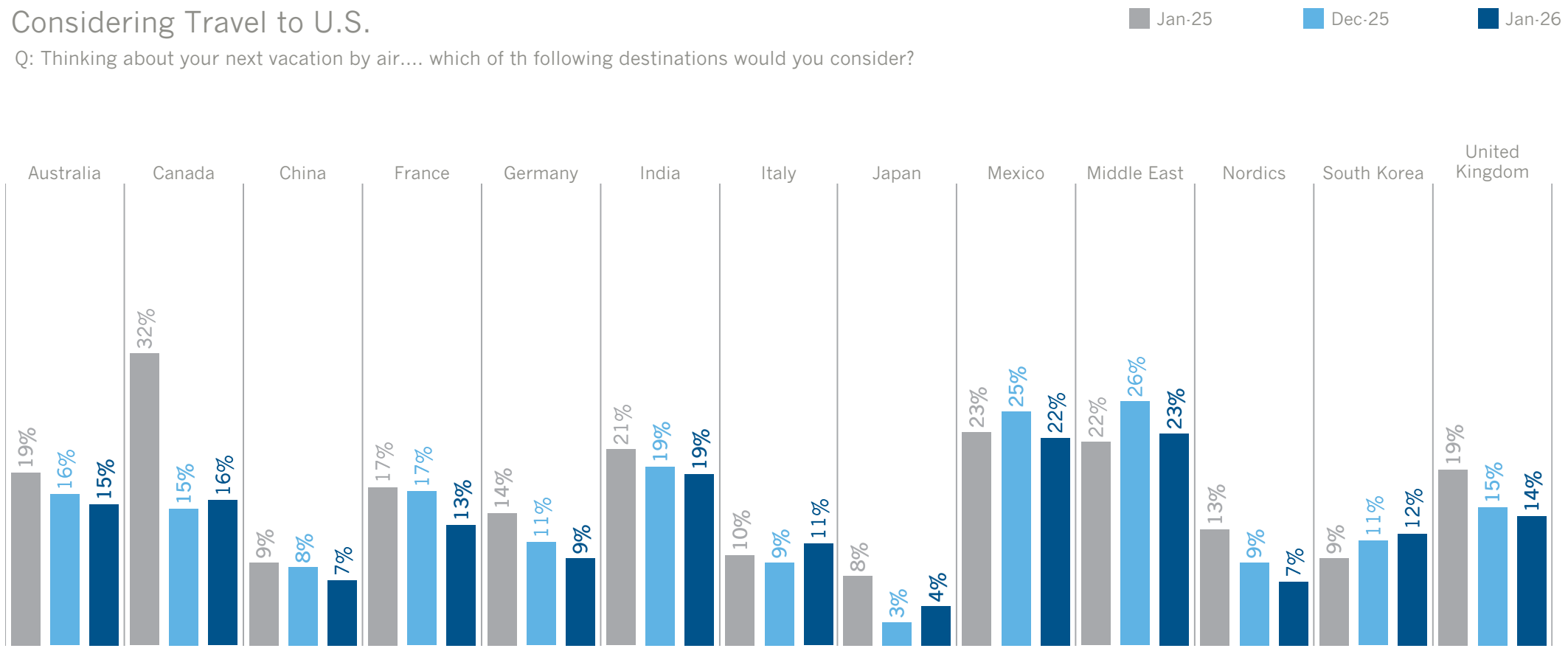


*Based on respondents in Australia, Canada, China, Germany, France, India, Italy, Mexico, Middle East, Nordics, South Korea, & UK

Source: YouGov

Travel Intent (to U.S.)

The chart below shows the percent of consumers in the market considering travel to the U.S. in the next 12 months.



Source: YouGov

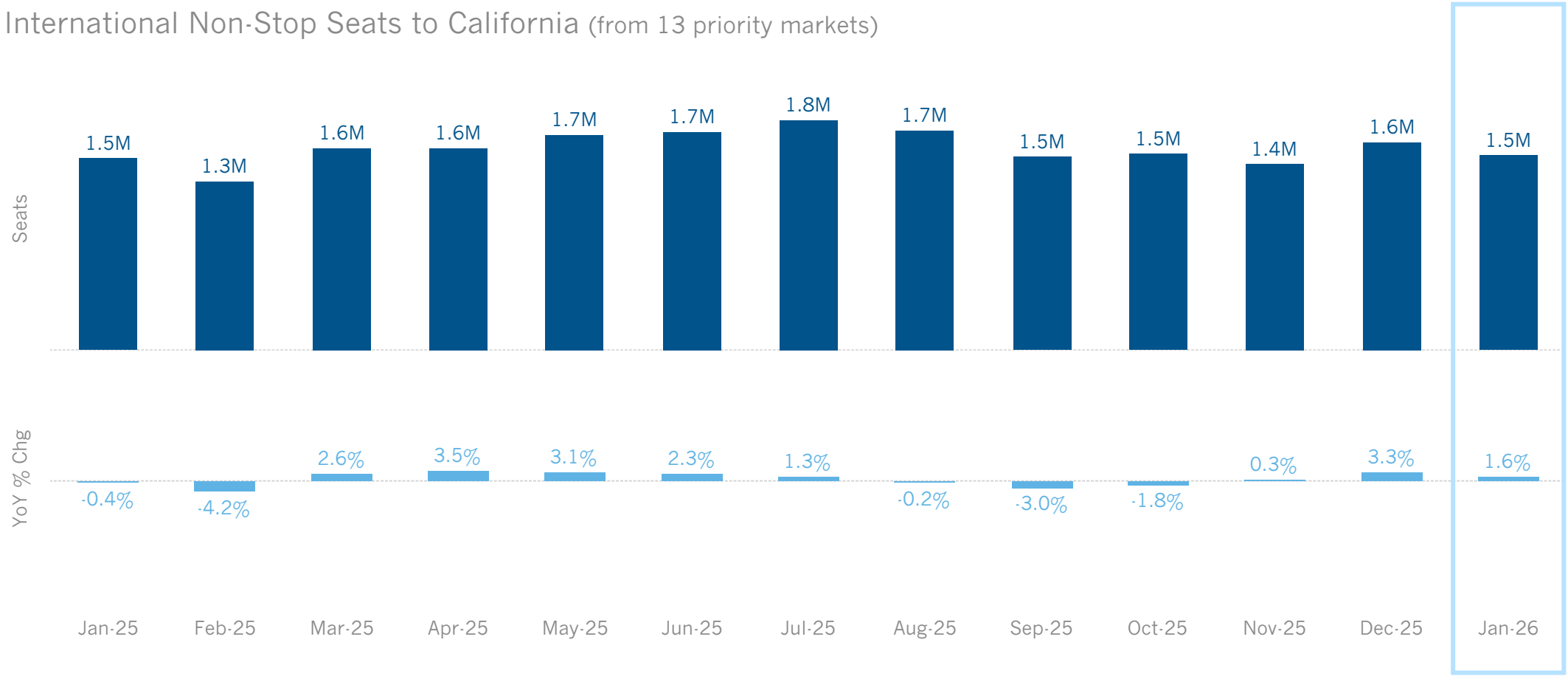
International Indicators:

Airlift & Arrivals

- International Non-Stop Seats
- Non-Resident Arrivals

International Non-Stop Seats

The chart below shows monthly international non-stop seats to California and percent change for 13 priority markets.

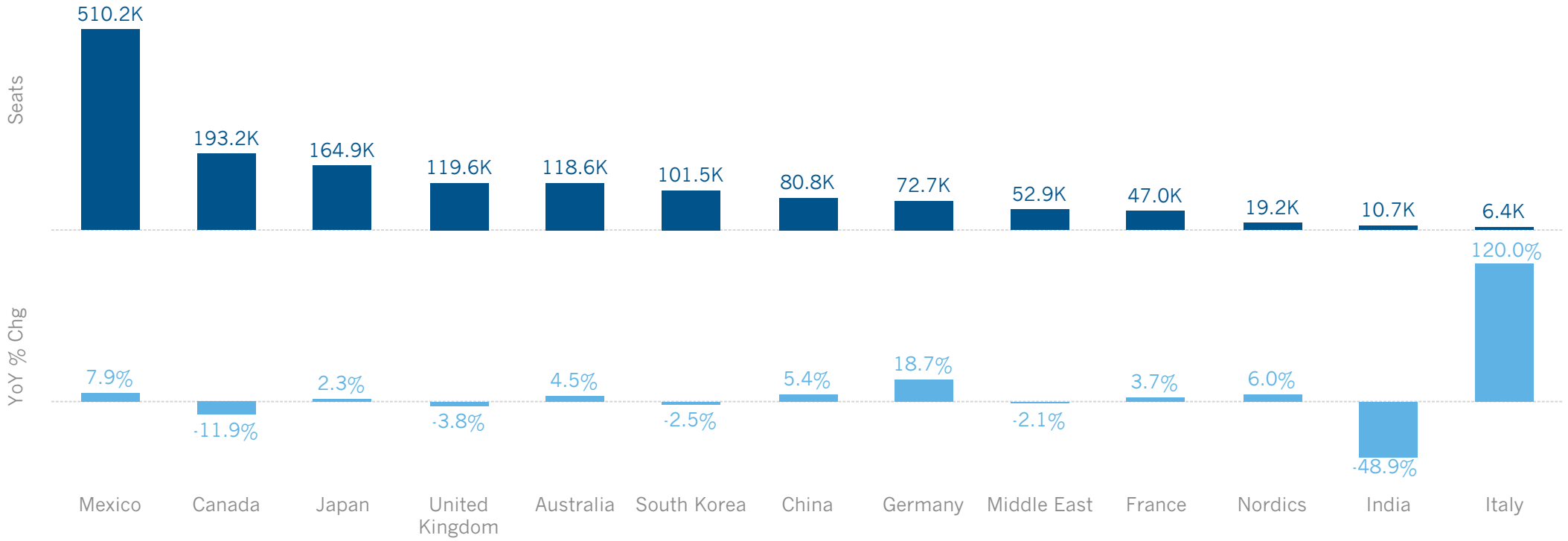


Source: Cirium

International Non-Stop Seats by Market

The chart below shows non-stop seats to California by priority international market for the reporting month.

International Non-Stop Seats to California by Market (January 2026)



Source: Cirium

International Non-Stop with YTD

The chart below shows non-stop seats to California by priority international markets for the reporting month.

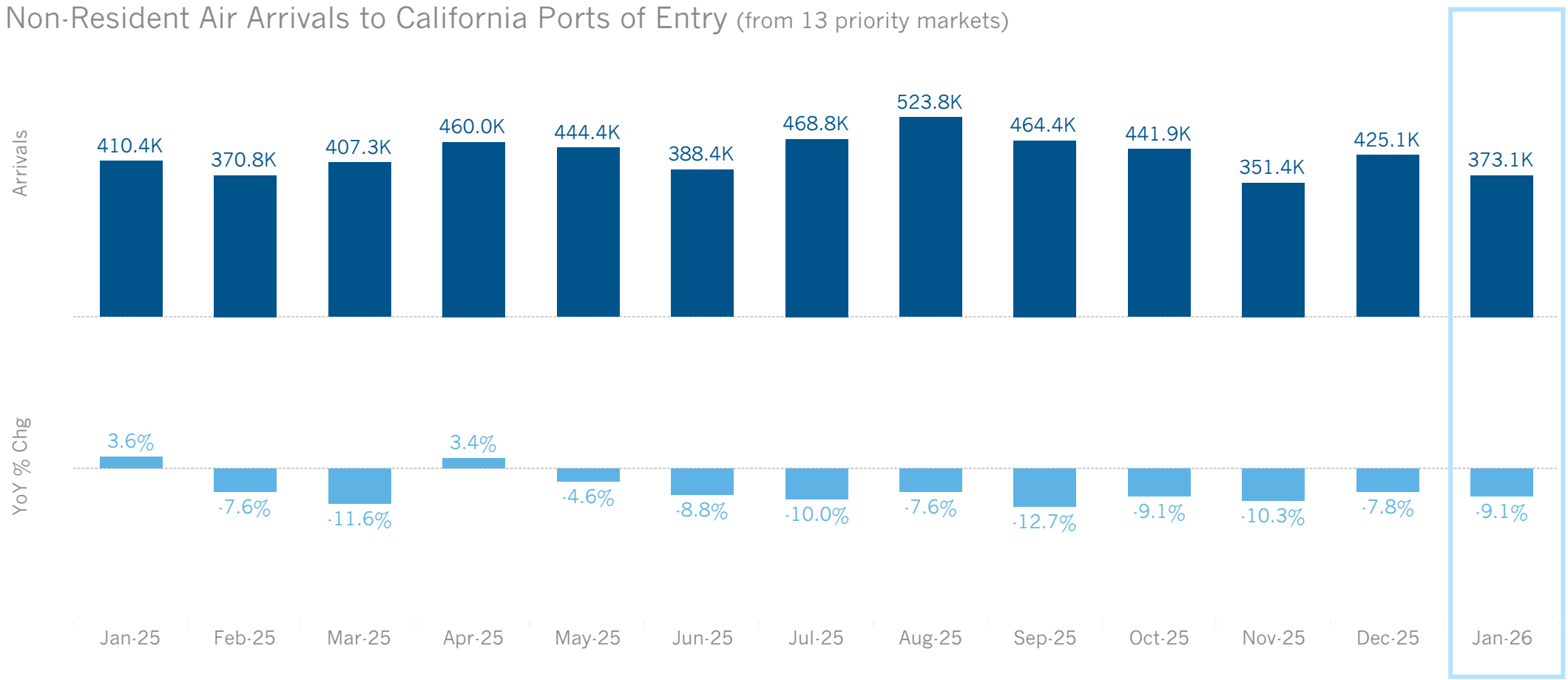
International Non-Stop Seats to California by Market (January 2026)

	Non-Stop Seats (month)	YoY % Chg (month)	YoY % Chg (YTD)
Total Priority Markets	1,497.7K	1.6%	1.6%
Mexico	510.2K	7.9%	7.9%
Canada	193.2K	-11.9%	-11.9%
Japan	164.9K	2.3%	2.3%
United Kingdom	119.6K	-3.8%	-3.8%
Australia	118.6K	4.5%	4.5%
South Korea	101.5K	-2.5%	-2.5%
China	80.8K	5.4%	5.4%
Germany	72.7K	18.7%	18.7%
Middle East	52.9K	-2.1%	-2.1%
France	47.0K	3.7%	3.7%
Nordics	19.2K	6.0%	6.0%
India	10.7K	-48.9%	-48.9%
Italy	6.4K	120.0%	120.0%

Source: Cirium

Non-Resident Air Arrivals

The chart below shows international non-resident air arrivals to any California port of entry by month and percent change.

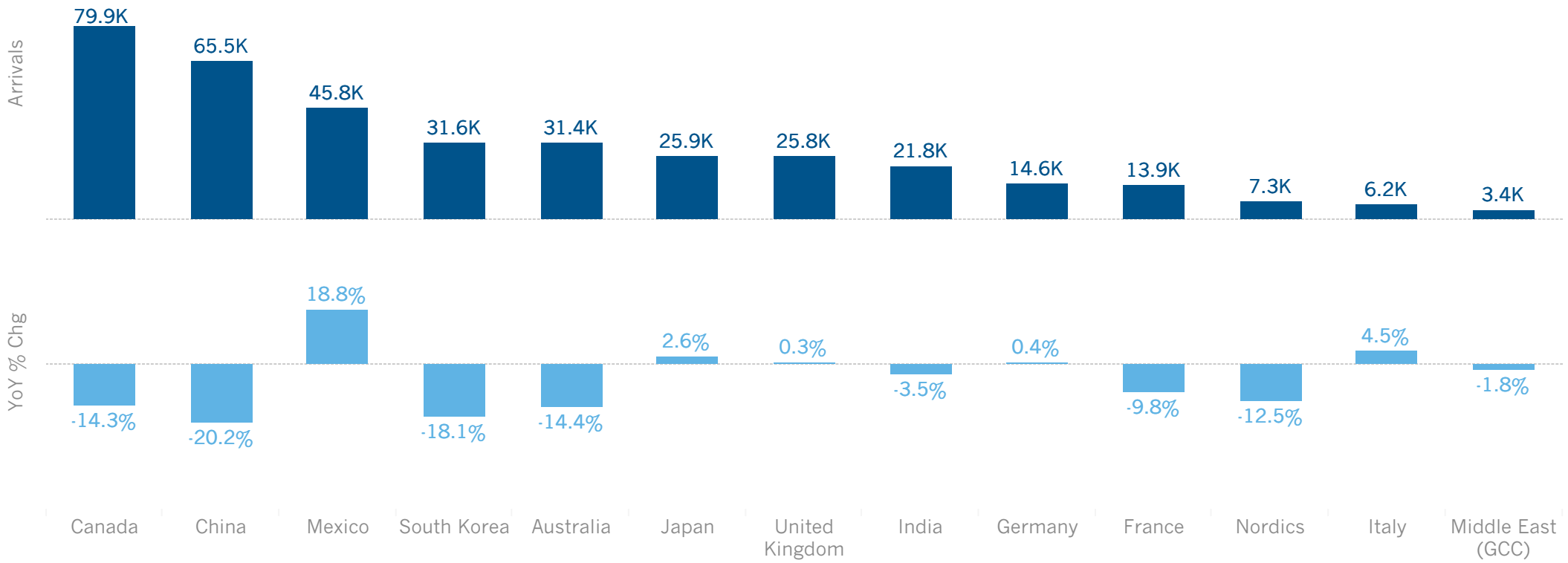


Source: NTTO/CIC Research

Non-Resident Air Arrivals by Market

The chart below shows non-resident air arrivals to any California port of entry by international market for the reporting month.

Non-Resident Air Arrivals to California Ports of Entry (January 2026)



Source: NTTO/CIC Research

Non-Resident Air Arrivals with YTD

The table below shows non-resident air arrivals to any California port of entry for the reporting month (with U.S. comparison).

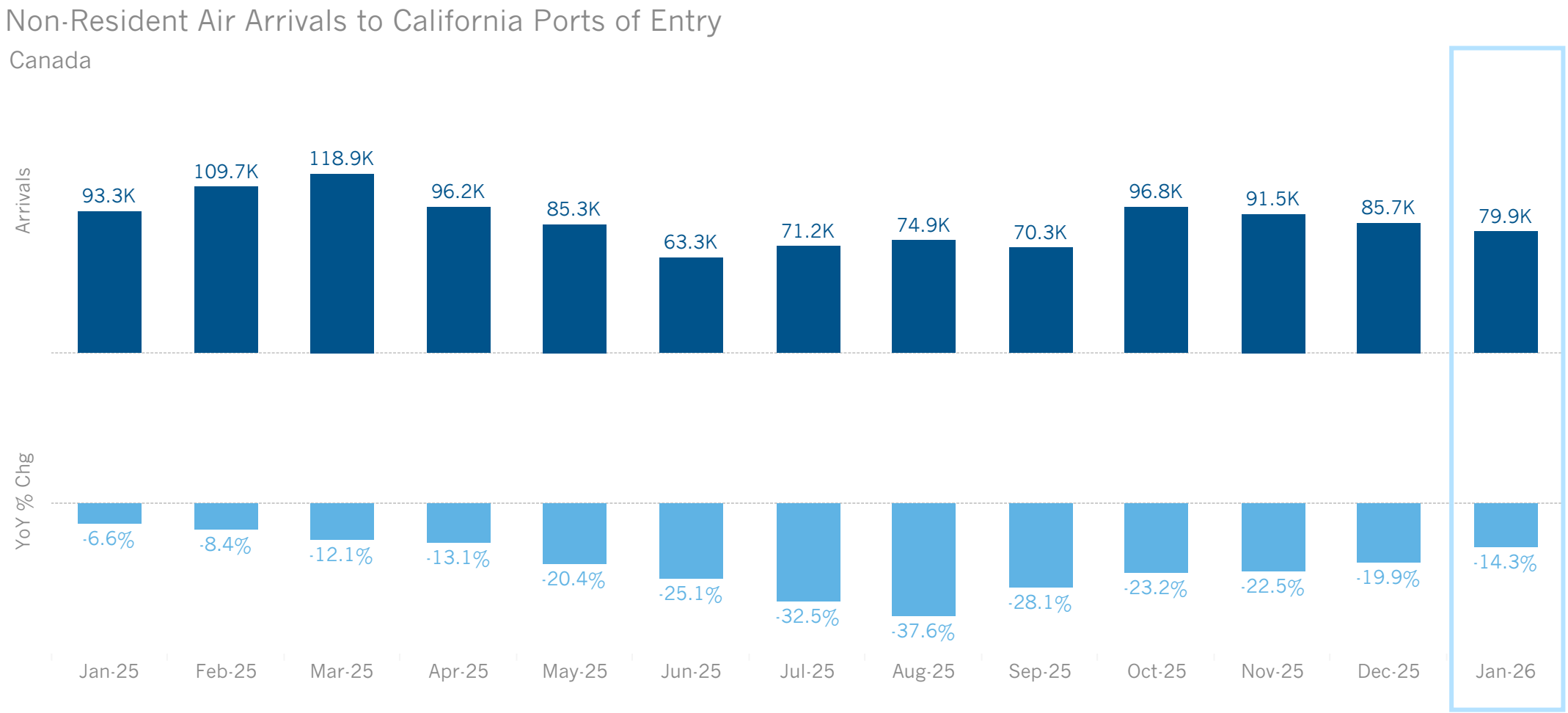
Non-Resident Air Arrivals to California & U.S. Ports of Entry (January 2026)

	All California POEs			All U.S. POEs		
Country	Arrivals (month)	YoY % Chg (month)	YoY % Chg (YTD)	Arrivals (month)	YoY % Chg (month)	YoY % Chg (YTD)
Total International	496.3K	-9.1%	-9.1%	2,989.0K	-5.8%	-5.8%
Total Priority Markets	373.1K	-9.1%	-9.1%	1,896.7K	-8.4%	-8.4%
Total Overseas	370.5K	-10.5%	-10.5%	2,185.2K	-4.1%	-4.1%
Canada	79.9K	-14.3%	-14.3%	565.7K	-16.0%	-16.0%
China	65.5K	-20.2%	-20.2%	147.9K	-19.3%	-19.3%
Mexico	45.8K	18.8%	18.8%	238.1K	7.1%	7.1%
South Korea	31.6K	-18.1%	-18.1%	140.0K	-7.9%	-7.9%
Australia	31.4K	-14.4%	-14.4%	64.7K	-11.6%	-11.6%
Japan	25.9K	2.6%	2.6%	141.0K	8.4%	8.4%
United Kingdom	25.8K	0.3%	0.3%	207.9K	0.8%	0.8%
India	21.8K	-3.5%	-3.5%	106.3K	-16.5%	-16.5%
Germany	14.6K	0.4%	0.4%	79.5K	-9.3%	-9.3%
France	13.9K	-9.8%	-9.8%	76.6K	-4.5%	-4.5%
Nordics	7.3K	-12.5%	-12.5%	44.2K	-11.6%	-11.6%
Italy	6.2K	4.5%	4.5%	62.9K	0.1%	0.1%
Middle East (GCC)	3.4K	-1.8%	-1.8%	21.8K	-5.1%	-5.1%

Source: NTTO/CIC Research

Non-Resident Air Arrivals (Canada)

The chart below shows international non-resident air arrivals from Canada to any California port of entry by month and percent change.



Source: NTTO/CIC Research